

Frankenstein

The Hesitations

Surviving text on paper. Deleted text on vellum.

Frankenstein; or, The Modern Prometheus (MS. Abinger c. 56, Volume I)
The Shelley-Godwin Archive, github.com/umd-mith/sga (data/tei/ox/ox-ms_abinger_c56)

23348 surviving words · 4055 erased words
2028 deletions · 1879 micro · 149 macro
Erasure ratio 14.8%

Key to the erasures

-  Tone shift — a word swapped for another in the same breath (≤ 3 words, replaced)
-  Structural cut — more than 3 words, or a cut running across lines
-  Rhythm adjustment — a false start, doubled word, fragment or bare removal

Bottom bar: dark = surviving words, colour = erased words. Margin ticks: dark = kept characters per line, colour = erased characters per line.

. ~~A12~~
. A 11
- Autograph
- Part of the MS of
- Frankenstein
- pp 64-172 (of vol I.?)
- ch. 6-17
- vol. II. pp 1-150
- ch I-XIV
- Corrections in another
- hand
- Dep. c. 477/1

The first fragment contains
pp. 24-97 of the Standard
Novel edition.
The second pp. 104-202, with
a slight interruption.
The third pp. 168-202, with
many imperfections.

—
—
-
—
—
—
—

Chapt. 2
Those events which materially influence our future destinies ~~are~~ often ~~caused by slight or~~ derive thier origin from a trivial occurence ~~s~~ . ~~Strange as the statement of the simple fact~~ ~~may appear my fate had been~~ Chemist Natural philosophy ~~has~~ is the genius that has regulated my fate I ~~wish~~ desire the ~~ir~~ refore in this account of my early years to state those facts which led to my ~~love pursuit first aqu~~ ~~of that study~~: predeliction for that science. When I was eleven years old we all went on a party of pleasure to ~~Thonon~~ the baths near Thonon. ~~and were confined there~~ ~~b~~ ~~obil~~ ~~obliged by the rain~~ and ~~t~~ The inclemency of the weather obliged us to remain a day confined to the inn. In this house I chanced to find ~~ed~~ d a ~~fe~~ volume ~~s~~ of the Works of Cornelius Agrippa. ~~And~~ I opened it with apathy ~~but~~ the theory that he attempted to demonstrate and the wonderful facts that he relates ~~chan~~ soon changed this feeling into ~~continued to re with~~ enthusiasm. A new light dawned upon my mind and ~~t~~ ~~com~~ bounding with joy I communicated my discovery to my father. I cannot help here remarking the many opportunities ~~parents~~ instructors ~~have~~ possess of directing the attention of their pupils to useful knowledge, which they utterly neglect. My father looked carelessly at the title page of my book — ~~Ah~~ and said Ah! Cornelius Agrippa! — My dear Victor do not waste your time upon this – it is sad trash. If instead of this remark or rather exclamation my father had taken the pains to expound ~~ound~~ lain to me that the principles of

Agrippa had been entirely exploded. ~~And~~ ~~aan~~ and that ~~another~~ a modern system of science had been introduced which possessed much greater power than the ancient because the powers of the ancient were pretended and chimerical, while those of the moderns are real and practical; under such circumstances I should certainly have thrown Agrippa aside, and with my imagination warmed as it was ~~w~~ should probably have applied myself to ~~m~~ the more ~~ra~~ rational theory of chemistry which ~~has at present~~ has resulted from modern discoveries ~~the approbation of the learned~~: It is even possible that the train of my ideas might never have recieved that fatal impulse which led me to my ruin. But the cursory glance my father had taken of my volume by no means assured me that he was acquainted with ~~the~~ its contents; and I continued to read with the greatest avidity. When I returned home, my first care was to procure ~~this~~ the whole works of this author and afterwards those of Paracelsus and Albertus Magnus. I read and studied the wild fancies of these authors with delight, they appeared to me treasures known to few besides myself; and, although I often wished to ~~discover~~ communicate these secret stores of knowledge ~~from~~ to my father yet his in

— definite censure of my favorite Agrippa,
— . always withheld me. ~~He~~t I disclosed my secret
— to Elizabeth therefore, under a strict promise
— of secrecy; but she did not interest herself
— . in ~~them m y~~ the subject, and I was left by her to pursue
— my studies alone. —
— It may appear very strange that a desc
— ple of Albertus Magnus should arise in the
— eighteenth century, but our family was not
— . scientifical, and I ~~did~~ had not attended any of the
— lectures given at Geneva. My dreams were
— therefore undisturbed by reality, and I entered
— with the greates diligence into the search
— . of the philosophers stone and the or if you chose petrum philosophale ~~elizer~~~~vi~~ elixer of life
— ~~tæ~~ . But the latter obtained my most undi
— . ved attention; wealth was an inferior
— object but what would be the glory
— of the discovery if I could ~~besto forever~~
— . banish disease from the human frame
— and render man ~~unatainable~~ ~~by~~ invulnerable to any
— .

— b ut a violent death.
— Nor were these my only visions, the
— raising of ghosts or devils ~~was also a favour~~ was a promise liberally accorded by
— . ~~ite pursuit and If I never saw any~~ my favourite authors; the fulfilment of which I most eagerly
— . sought;
— & if my incantations were always unsuccessfulattributed ~~it~~ the failure rather to my own
— . inexperience
— ~~th~~ and mistake, than to a want of skill or fidelity in
— my instructors.
— . ~~When I was about fifteen my f~~
— The natural phænonema that takes
— place every day before our eyes did not
— escape my exa ~~n~~ mi ~~m~~ nations. ~~I remember The~~
— . ~~fermentation of liquors~~ — ~~di~~ stillation of which
— my favorite authors were utterlyno ignorant
— excited my astonishment, but my utmost
— wonder was ~~caused by an~~ engaged by some experiements ~~air pump electrical machine~~ on an air
— . pump
— which I saw employed ~~used~~ by a gentleman whom
— we were in the habit of visiting.
— . The ignorance of my philosopher ~~es~~ s on these
— and several other points, served to decrease

thier credit with me – but I could not entirely throw
them aside before ~~any~~ ~~some~~ some other system ~~coce~~ should
occup ~~ie~~ y d their place : , in my mind–
~~An d~~ Among other questions suggested by natural objects I ~~as~~ eagerly enquired of my father
~~what~~ the nature & the origin of thunder and lightening. ~~was~~: He
replied, electricity; describing at the same
time the effect of that power. He ~~made~~ constructed
a small electrical machine and exhi
bited a few experiments and made a
kite with a wire & string ~~and~~ which drew down
that fluid from the clouds.
This last ~~blow st~~ stroke completed
the overthrow of Cornelius Agrippa, Albertus
Magnus and Paracelsus, who had so long
reigned the lords of my imagination. But
by some fatality I did not feel enclined to
commence any modern system and this
~~inclination~~ disinclination was influenced by the following
circumstance.
My father expressed a wish that I
should attend a course of lectures upon
natural philosophy, to which I cheerfully consented ~~and~~
~~one evening that I spent in town at the~~
~~heard that house of Clerval's father I~~
~~M a proficient met M: r — was lef at O-P~~
~~in Chemistry who left the company at~~
~~an early hour to give his lecture upon h~~
~~science enquiring as he went out t tha n~~

~~I went him if any one would but~~ Some accident prevented my attending the ~~series of~~ these
lectures
~~this lecture was unfortunately nearly the~~ until ~~they were nearly over they~~ it was nearly finihsed.
The
~~last~~ lecture which I attended being thus ~~the~~ almost the last ~~in his~~ in his course was entirely
incomprehensible to me. – the professor talked
with the greatest fluency of potassium &
Boron ~~zinc bismuth~~ – of sulphats and oxids
~~and displayed so many words~~ terms to which
I could ~~not~~ affix ~~any~~ no idea: ~~that~~ I was
disgusted with ~~the appearance of~~ a science
that appeared to me to contain only words.
From this time untill I went to
Colledge I entirely neglected my formerly
adored study of ~~chemistry~~ the science of natural philosophy although I still
read with delight Pliny and Buffons
authors ~~that stood about on a par ar of~~
in my estimation of nearly equal interest & utility.
My ~~studies~~ occupations at this age were ~~th~~ principally the
mathematics, ~~which I delighted in an~~ and most
of the branches of study appertaining ~~th~~ to that
science. I was also busily employed in learning
languages Latin was already familiar to me and I began to
read without the help of the ~~dictionary~~ lexicon some of the
easiest greek authors. –I also understood English &
german perfectly: th ~~ese~~ is ~~are~~ is list of my accom-
plishments at ~~that time th e period~~ the age of and you may
conceive that my hours were fully employd
in acquiring and maintaining a knowledge
of this various literature.

servants had any request to make
it always through ~~the~~ her intercession ~~of~~
~~Elizabeth~~ For me I loved ~~he~~ We agreed
perfectly although there were many
There For, although
was a great dissimilitude in our
characters. I was more calm and phi
losphical than my companion
Yet I was not ~~n~~ so mild or yielding.
My application was of longer endurance
than ~~hers~~ but it was not so severe
as ~~hers~~ while st it ~~lasted~~ endured my amusements
were studying old books of chemistry
and natural magic those of Elizabeth were
drawing & music.
When I ~~had~~ My brothers were consi
derably younger than myself but I had
a friend ~~who~~ ~~who~~ in one of my school
fellows who compensated for this. deficiency. Henry
Carignan Clerval was the son s of a merchant
an of Geneva and an intimate friend
of my father 's – he was a boy of singu
lar talent & ~~fancy~~ fancy I remember
when he was only nine years old he
wrote a fairy tale which was the
delight and amazement of all his
companions. Like Don Quixote his
favourite study ~~was~~ consisted in books of chi
valry & romance and when very young, I can remember that we used to
act plays composed by him out of
th ~~is~~ ese favourite books, the principal
car characters of which were Orlando
Robin Hood, Amadis and St. George–
No youth could could be more happy
X
X
yet
there was an
harmony in
that very diss
imilitude–
We were strangers
to any species
of disunion
or dispute
I delighted in
investigating
the facts relating
to the actual
world, she
busied herself
in following the aerial
creations of the
poets.– The
world was to me
a secret which
I desired to disco
-ver,–to her it
was a haven
vacancy which
she sought to
people with
imaginations of
her own.

than mine. – ~~Our~~ My parents were indul
gent, and my companions amiable.
and our stud Our studies were never
forced, and by some means we al
ways had an end placed in view which
excited us to ardour. in the prosecution of them. It was by this & method
not by emulation that we were
urged. Elizabeth was not told to apply
herself to drawing or that her companions
would might not outstrip her, but she by was the
knew how pleas ed ing her Aunt would
be by a painting the representation of some of her
favourite scene s done by her own
hand. Latin We learned Latin &
English to that we might read the writ ers ings of in those
languages and so far from study
begin rendered odious by to us th rough
punishment, we loved application
and our amusements were would have been the
labours of other children. perhaps
we did not read so many books
or learn a languages so quickly
as another child those who are disciplined according to the ordinary method, but what we
learned was impressed the more deeply on our
memory. I include Hen Henry Carignan Clerval,
in this account for he was eon constantly
with us. he went to sho school
with me and generally passed
the afternoon at our house for
desire of
In this the descrip
tion of our do
mestic circle
I include

— being an only child, and desti
— . tute of companions at home, h is is
— . to father was pleased that he
— should find associates at our
— house and we were never com
— pletely happy when Clerval was
— absent.
— In this account of my early
— men youth I wish particularly to
— those circumstances tion which
— led to and nourished my taste
— for that science which was
— the principal amusement of my
— boyish days and in the end deci
— . I mentioned before ded my destiny
— my taste for old books of chemist
— ry and natural magic and I remem
— ber very well that I learned latin
— principally that I might read
— Pliny's Natural History my father
— refusing to allow me to read a
— translation. I used when very young
— to attend lectures of chemistry
— given in Geneva and although
— I did not understand them the
— experiments never failed to
— attract my attention. I reme ber m
— . also w W hen I was about twelve fourteen years
— old we were at our house near
— . Belrive when we witnessed the a
— . violent at and terrible thunder storm
— . record

it advanced from behind Jura and
the and the thunder was heard at
once from d the several quarte rs
of the heavens and burst at once with and
frightful loudness. from various quarters of the heavens I e witnessed th is
elemental storm with pleasure
and remained while it the storm lasted at watching its
the door watchin g . When it was most As I stood at the door
violent , on a sudden I beheld the a stream of fire issue
from an old be and beautiful
oak about wh twenty yards from
our house and when so soon as the dazz
dazzling light had dissa disappeared
the pa vanished, the oak hand
had dissappeared an & nothing remained but a
rent blasted stump. remained . When we
visited it the next morning we found
the trea tree shattered in a
singular manner. It was not splin
tered by the shock, but entirely
reduced to thin ribands of wood. The
E I never saw any thing so utterly
destroyed. The catastrophe of the
tree excited my extreme astonish
ment induced and caused me to aply wi ith
ligence to the study of fresh di
natural philosophy which promised an ex- chemistry
i planation of th se sort of clamatio e
its progress
with curiosity
& delight

— phænonema. On Elizabeth and
— Clerval it produced a very different di
— effect. They admired the beauty
— of the storm without wishing to
— analyze its causes. Henry said that
— the Fairies and giants were at
— war and Elizabeth attempted
— a picture of it.
— As I grew older my attempts
— in science were of a higher nature:
— I produced little earthquakes endeavou
— and tried every kind of combination
— and elements to ascertain of gasses to
— the results.
— As I before mentioned my brothers
— were much younger than myself.
— Ernest the second of our family was five
— . Another task soon also devolved upon
— me when I became the instructor
— of my brothers. Ernest was five years
— younger than myself, and was my
— principal pupil. He had been afflicted
— . with ill health from his infancy & thro which
— Elizabeth and I had been his constant
— . m nurses † his disposition was gentle but
— he was incapable any severe appli
— . cation. William the younge er st of our
— family was quite a child and the
— most beautiful little fellow in the
— world, his lively blue eyes dimpled cheeks

and affectionate endearing manners
inspired the tenderest affection. Such
was our domestic circle from which
care and pain seemed for ever banish
ed. ‡ My father directed our studies
and my mother partook of our
enjoyments. we were all equal the
voice of command was never heard
among us but mutual affection
engaged us all to comply with, & to
obey the slightest desire of each
other.

we none neither of
us possessed
an envied
preheminance
over the other

Chapter 23
When I had attained the age of
seventeen my father parents resolved that
I should go to at the university of In-
golstadt. I had hitherto attended the
schools of Geneva, but my father thought
it necessary for the completion of my
education that that I should be
acquainted with other customs besides than
those of my native country. My depar-
ture was therefore fixed for at an
early date. But before the day resolved
upon could arrive the first mis-
fortune of my life occurred: as if an
omen as it were of my future misery if
I should prosecute my journey.
>Elizabeth had caught the scar-
let fever but her illness was
not severe and she quickly recovered.
During her confinement madly made many ar-
guments had been urged to persuade
my mother not a to refrain from to attend upon
her. She had yielded the to these to our entreaties, but
when she ha heard that her
favourite was recovering, she w c ould
no longer debar herself from her
society, and entered her sick cham-
ber long before it was safe the danger of infection was past . The
become a student
made

consequences of this imprudence were
fatal: on the third day my mother
sickened. Her fever was very malig-
nant, tr and the looks of her atten-
dants prognosticated the worst worst
evil. On her death bed the forti-
tude and benignity di of my mother this admirable woman
did not desert her. She joined the
hands of Elizabeth and myself. “My
“children said she it was on your
“union that my firmest hopes of
“future happiness were placed. It
“will now be the consolation of
“your father father. alone Elizabeth, my
“love, supply my place to the other
“your young cons cousins. Alas! I
“almost regret being than I am taken from you,
“h and happy and beloved, as I am
“is it not hard to quit you all? But
“these are not thoughts befitting me
“I will endeavour to resign myself to cheerfully to
“death and will indulge a hope my
“beloved creatures of meeting you
“in another world.”
She died calmly and her features
expressed lov affection even in death.
I need not describe the feelings of those

— whose dearest ties are rent by that
— . most irreperable evil; the ~~bla~~ void
— that every where presents itself to
— - ~~their minds~~ the soul and the despair that
— is exhibited on the countenance.
— It is so long before the mind can
— persuade itself that she, whom
— they saw every day, and whose very
— existence appeared a part of theirs,
— . can have departed for ever: ~~T~~ t hat
— the brightness of a loved eye can have
— - ~~faded~~ been extinguished, and the sound of a voice ~~never~~
— so familiar and dear to the ear
— can be hushed, never more to be
— heard. These are the reflections of the
— first days. But when the lapse of
— time proves the reality of the evil
— - then the ~~true despair~~ bitterness of grief commences,
— . ~~Then the survivors dare not turn~~
— - ~~But~~ Yet, from whom who has not ~~had some dear~~
— - ~~connection rent away by~~ that rude hand
— . and why ~~need~~ should I describe a sorrow
— which all have felt, and must
— . feel? ~~But t~~ T he time at length arrives
— when grief is rather an indulgence
— . a than a necessity and the smile
— that plays on the lips, although
— it is deemed sacrilege, is not Ba
— - nished.— My mother ~~was gone~~ lost ~~had be en~~
— - ~~taken away~~ was dead but we had still
— rent away some
— dear connection,

— duties which we ought to perform
— we must continue our course with
— the rest ~~& bless God if nothing else worse hap~~
— pens : ~~and the idleness generated by grief would become a bad habit if further indulged~~
— My journey to Ingolstadt which had
— been deferred by these events was now
— again determined upon, ~~and all that~~
— I ~~could~~ obtained from my father ~~was~~ a
— respite of some weeks. This time
— was spent sadly. My mothers death
— and my speedy departure depressed
— our spirits but Elizabeth endeavour
— ed to ~~spr~~ ~~renew the spirit~~ ~~a gleam~~ ~~cast a~~ renew the spirit of cheer
— fullness in our little society. Since
— the death of her aunt her mind
— acquired new ~~firmiss~~ firmness and
— vigour. She determined to fulfil her
— duties with the greatest exactitude
— and ~~her~~ she felt that the most imperious duty ~~was~~ of
— ~~to~~ rendering her uncle and cousins hap
— py. She consoled me, amused her uncle,
— ~~and~~ instructed my brothers and I never
— beheld her so enchanting as at this
— time when she ~~sar~~ ~~sacrifised every~~
— ~~minut e of her time to others~~ was continual
— ly endeavouring to contribute to the
— happiness of others entirely forgetful
— and learn
— to think our
— -selves fortu
— nate, ~~if no~~
— ~~more~~ whilst
— one remains
— whom the
— spoiler has
— not seized. had
— had devolved
— on her.

— . of ~~hels~~ herself.
— The day of my departure at length
— arrived – I had taken leave of all
— my friends excepting Clerval, who spent
— the last evening with us. He bitterly la-
— . mented that he was ~~not able~~ unable to
— accompany me But his father
— . could not ~~bear~~ be persuaded to part with him
— ~~besides as he~~ intend ~~ed~~ ing ~~him to~~ that he should be-
— come a partner with him in
— ~~his business, and~~ ~~he said he did not~~
— ~~see of what use learning was could be to a~~
— ~~merchant.~~ Henry had a refined mind
— ~~and a~~ he ~~did not wish~~ had no desire to be idle
— . and was well pleased to become ~~the~~
— ~~partner of~~ his father’s partner but he believed
— that a man might be a very good
— trader and yet ~~have~~ posess a cultivated
— . ~~mind:~~ understanding.
— We sate late listening to his com-
— . plaints, and ~~†~~ making many little
— . arrangements for the future. ~~and †~~ T he
— next morning early I departed. Tears
— gushed from the eyes of Elizabeth
— they proceeded partly from sorrow
— at my departure, and partly because
— she reflected that the same journey
— was to have taken place three
— months before when a mothers
— blessing would have accompanied me
— . ~~and~~ in
— compliance
— with his favou-
— rite theory,
— . that ~~the~~ learning
— was superflous
— in the com-
— merce of ordi-
— nary life.

— I threw myself into the chaise
— that was to convey me away and in
— dulged in the most melancholy reflec-
— tions. I who had ever been surrounded
— by amiable companions, continually
— engaged in ~~ed~~ endeavouring to give
— mutual pleasure; I was now alone.
— In the university ~~wi~~ whither I was
— going I must form my own friends
— and be my own ~~introduction~~ : protector. My
— life had hitherto been remarkably retired
— and domestic and this had given me
— an invincible repugnance to new ~~faces~~
— countenances. I loved my brothers Eliza-
— beth and Clerval these were “old
— familiar faces” but I believed my
— self totally unfitted for the compa-
— ny of strangers. Such were my reflec-
— tions as I commenced my journey But
— as I proceeded my spirits and hopes
— rose. I ardently desired knowledge
— ~~and †~~ often when at home
— thought ~~how~~ it hard ~~it was~~ to remain
— cooped up in one place ~~all my~~
— ~~life~~ and had longed to enter into the
— ~~worth~~ world and take my ~~place~~
— ~~with~~ among other human beings. ~~And~~
— now my desires were ~~eop~~ complied
— with & it would indeed have ~~be indeed~~ been folly to
— repent.
— I had ~~plenty of~~ sufficient leisure for these
— I had
— during my youth
— station

— and many other reflections during
— my journey to Ingolstadt which was
— long and fatiguing – at length the
— steeples of the town met my eyes. I
— alighted and was conducted to my
— solitary apartment to spend the
— evening as I pleased.

Chap. 4
The next morning I delivered my
letters of introduction and paid a
visit to some of the principal
professors. and among others to M. ~~K~~ —
Professor of ~~& Lecturer upon~~ Natural
philosophy. He received me with
politeness, and asked me several
questions concerning my progress
in the ~~sciences~~ different branches
of science appertaining to natural
philosophy. I mentioned, it is true
with fear and trembling, the only
authors I had ever read upon those
subjects. The professor stared. ~~I said~~
~~that I did not mention these~~
“Have you really” said ~~“~~ he “spent
“your time in studying such
“nonsense?” I replied in the affir
mative.
“Every minute”– continued M. ~~K~~ —
with warmth,” every instant that
“you have wasted upon those
“books is utterly and entirely lost.
“You have burdened your ~~bur~~
“ ~~memor~~ memory with exploded
“systems and useless names. Good
“God ~~where must you~~ in what desart land have you
“lived where no one was kind
“enough to ~~enfor~~ inform you
“that these fancies which you have
 ~~Krempe~~ Krempe
 Krempe

— . “so greedily imbibed are ~~at~~le a
— “thousand years old and as musty as
— . “~~you~~r they are ancient. I little expected
— “in this enlightened and scientific age
— “to find a disciple of Albertus Mag
— nus and Paracelsus. My dear sir
— “you must begin your studies entire
— . “ly anew.” So saying he ste ~~ss~~ pp ed aside, and
— . ~~wh~~ wrote down a list of several
— . books ~~u~~ upon natural philosophy
— which he desired me to procure
— and dismissed me after mentioning
— that ~~he intended to commen~~ in
— the beginning of the next week
— he intended to commence a course
— of lectures upon natural philosophy
— . and that M. W. ~~—~~ aldham a fellow professor
— would lecture upon chemistry
— the alternate days which he missed.
— I returned home not dissapointed
— for I had long considered the au-
— thors useless which the professor
— had so strongly reprobated – but I
— did not feel very much enclined
— . to ~~bu~~ study those books which at
— . his ~~recon~~ recomondation I had
— . procured. M. K ~~—~~ rempe was a little squat
— man with a gruff voice and repul
— sive countenance and the teacher
— did not prepossess me in favour
— in its general relations;

of his ~~science~~ : doctrine. ~~But when the ne~~ Be-
sides I had a contempt for the uses
of modern ~~chemistry~~ natural philosophy . It was very
~~when~~ different when the ~~n~~ masters
of the science sought immortality
and ~~wealth~~ power ;– such views although
futile were grand; but now ~~it~~ the scene was
~~all~~ changed. ~~t and the expulsion~~
~~of chimera overthrew at the same~~
~~time all greatness in the science~~ ~~those~~
Such were my reflections during
~~tw~~ two or three days spent almost in ~~solitary~~
but ~~at~~ as the ensuing week
commenced I thought of the infor
mation Mr. K. ~~—~~ rempe had given me
concerning the lectures, and although
I could not consent to go and hear
that little conceited fellow deliver
sentences out of a pulpit I recollected what he had
said of Mr. Waldham, whom I had
never seen ~~and~~ as he had been
hitherto out of town.
~~Half out of~~ Partly from curiosity and partly from
idleness I went into the lecturing room
which Mr. Waldham entered shortly
after. This Professor was a very dif
ferent man from ~~the other~~ his colleague . He
was about fifty but with aspect ex-
pressive of the greatest benevolence
a few grey ~~hars~~ hairs covered his temples
the ~~utmost~~
ambition of
enquirer seemed
to limit itself
to the annihi
lation of those
visions on which
solitude:
my interest in science
was chiefly founded.
I was required
to exchange
chimeras of
boundless grandeur,
for realities of
little worth.

— but those at the back of his head —
— were nearly black. He was short in —
— person but remarkably erect **ha** and —
— his voice the sweetest I had ever —
— heard. He began his lecture with a —
— **kind of** history of chemistry and **remark-** —
— **ed** the various improvements **& discoveries** **diffe** —
— **rent** men **had made** of learning pronouncing —
— the names of the greatest discoverers —
— **with great warmth** . He then took —
— a cursory view of the present state —
— of **chemistry** the science, and explained many —
— of its **termes** terms. **made** After making a few —
— preparatory experiments **and** he conclu —
— ded with a panegyric upon modern chemist —
— ry the words of which I shall never —
— forget.
— “The ancient teachers of this science” —
— said he, “promised impossibilities —
— “and performed nothing. The modern —
— “masters promise very little. They —
— “ **no** know that metals cannot be —
— “transmuted and that the elixir —
— “ **vitæ** is a **mere** chimæra. But —
— “these philosophers whose **eyes** hands —
— “appear only made to dabble in —
— “dirt and their eyes to pore over —
— “the microscope or cruscible, —
— “have indeed performed miracles. —
— “They penetrate into the recesses of —
— “nature and show how she works —
— by a recapitu —
— lation of the made by various with fervour of life

— “in her hiding places. They ascend into —
— “the heavens;– they have discoverd how —
— “the blood circulates, and the nature —
— “of the air we breathe. **New** They have —
— “acquired new and almost unlimi —
— ted powers ; ; – They can command the —
— “thunders of heaven, mimick the —
— “earthquake, and even mock the —
— “invisible world with its own —
— “shadows.” —
— I departed highly pleased with —
— the professor and his lecture & —
— paid him a visit the same evening. —
— His manners in private were even —
— more mild & attractive than in public. For —
— there was a certain dignity in his —
— manner during his lectures which —
— was replaced by the greatest **affability** —
— affability and kindness in his own —
— house. He heard **by** my little narration —
— concerning my studies with attention —
— smiled at the names of Cornelius —
— Agrippa and Paracelsus but without —
— the contempt that Mr Krempe had —
— **Ex exhibited** expressed to them . **tended by saying** that —
— his lecture had removed my prejudice —
— against modern chemists and I request- —
— ed at the same time his advice —
— concerning the books I ought to procure —
— He said that —
— these were —
— men to whose —
— indefatigable zeal —
— modern **chem** natural —
— philosophers were —
— indebted for most —
— of the foundations —
— of their knowledge —
— **it is not a meaner** —
— **task** They had left to —
— us, as an easier —
— task to give new —
— names, & arrange —
— in conected classi —
— fications the —
— facts which they —
— to a great degree —
— **ha v d e** been the —
— instruments of —
— bringing to light. —
— The labours of —
— men of genius —
— however erroneously —
— directed scarce —
— ly ever failed. —

— “I am happy” said Mr. Waldham, “To
— . “have gained a ~~desce~~ desciple and if if your
— . “~~appti~~ application equals your ability
— “I have no doubt of your success. Che
— “mistry is that branch of natural
— “philosophy in which the greatest im-
— “provements have been & may be made.
— . “It is on that account ~~s~~ that I sl
— “chose it for my peculiar study. But
— “at the same time I did not neglect the
— “other sciences. A man would make
— “a very sorry chemist if he atteneded
— to that department alone. If
— “your wish is really to become a
— “man of science and not merely
— “a pretty experimentalist I should
— . “advi ~~e~~ se you to apply to every
— . “branch of natural philosophy ~~and~~
— “Mathematics.”
— . — ~~He then gave me the list~~
— . — ~~I had requested and mentioned a few~~
— . — ~~machines that I ought to procure~~
— . — ~~and promising that when I should~~
— . — ~~have~~
— He then took me into his
— — ~~workroom~~ laboratory and ~~shewed a nd~~ explain
— . ed to me the use of his various machines ~~tel~~
— — ~~ling me~~ what I ~~should procure~~ ought to procure
— — ~~for my priva~~ and promising me
— . ~~a lone~~ the use of his own when I should
— . have advanced far ~~e~~ enough in
— . the study not to des ~~der~~ derange
— in ultimately
— turning to the
— solid advantage of
— mankind. I listen
— ed to his state
— ment which
— was delivered
— without any
— presumption
— & then added
— including
— instructing me as to

the ~~m~~ir . mechanism. He also gave me the list of
books which I had requested and
I took my leave.
Thus ended a day memorable
~~in a my life~~ to me for it decided my
destiny.

- Chap. 5
— From this day natural philosophy and parti
— . cularly chemistry became nearly my sole appli
— . study. I read with ardour m those books
— so full of genius and discrimination
— th at have been written on these sub-
— jects. I attended the lectures, and culti
— vated the acquaintance of the men
— of science of the university; and I found
— even in Mr Krempe a great deal
— of sound sense & real information
— combined it is true with a repulsive
— phisiognomy & manners, but not on
— that account the less valuable.
— In M. Waldman I found a true friend.
— . His gentleness was never tinged by dg
— dogmatism and his instructions were
— given with an air of frankness and
— good nature that banished every idea
— . of pedantl pedantry. It was perhaps the
— amiable character of this man that
— enclined me more to the study of that
— . branch of science natural philosophy which he professed than an intrinsic
— love for the science itself. But this
— . was only in the first steps towards the
— . knowledge; as the more fully I entered more fully into
— — the philosophy science the more I studied s pursued it
— for its own sake. That application
— which at first had been a matter
— . of ch duty & resolution, now became so ardent
— and eager that the stars often
— - dissapeared while I was yet labouring engaged
— in my labrotary.
— which modern
— enquirers
— . circumstance
— . of was had
— state of mind had
— place
— in the light of
— morning

As I applied so closely, it may be
easily conceived that I improved rapid
ly. # My ardour was indeed the astonish
ment of the students, and my proficiency
that of the master. and Professor Krempe
often asked me with a sly smile
how Cornelius Agrippa went on ; Two
years passed in this manner during
which I paid no visit to Geneva, but
ws was engaged heart and soul in the
pursuit of some discoveries which I
hoped to make. No-one None but those
who have experienced it can conceive
of the enticements of science— especially In
other studies you go as far as others have
dg one before you and there is nothing
more to learn ; know, learn, but in a scientific
pursuit their there is continual
food for discovery and wonder. A mind
of even moderate capacity who closely pursues
one study must infallibly arrive at
great proficiency in th e at study—And I
who was continually applied to sought the attainment of one
thing object and was wra pt up as I was in this sole
I improved so rapidly that at the end
of the two years I made one or two some
trifling discoveries in the improvement
of some chemical machines instruments which pro
cured me great esteem and admiration
at the university. When I arrived at
this point, that m y residence at In
while M. Waldham
expressed the most
heartfelt exultation
in my progress.
pursuit
and ha v d ng learned
all the professors
at Ingolstadt were
qualified to teach

— - golstadt was no longer conducive to
— my improvement, I thought of returning
— to my friends and to my native town,
— when an incident happened that
— protracted my stay.
— One of those phænonoma which
— had ~~mo st re~~ peculiarly attracted my atten
— tion was the structure of the human
— frame; and indeed that of any animal
— endued with life. Whence I often asked
— myself did this principle of life proceed.
— . It was a bold question, and one ~~that~~
— has ever been considered as a mystery.
— Yet how many things are we on the
— brink of becoming acquainted with
— if cowardice or carelessness did
— . not restrain ~~us~~ our enquiries? . I revolved these circum
— stances in my mind and determined
— from thenceforth to apply myself more
— particularly to th ~~at~~ ose branches of natural
— . philosophy which ~~treats of~~ relate to phisiology.
— Unless I had been animated by an al-
— most supernatural enthusiasm, my
— application to this study would have
— been irksome and almost intolerable.
— . To examine the causes of life ~~de~~ we must
— . first have ~~recou~~ recourse to death.
— - ~~No is ano anatomy~~ I became acquainted
— with the science of anatomy but this
— was not sufficient. I must also observe
— the natural decay & corruption of the
— human body. In my education
— there being
— . which

— my father had taken the greatest
— precautions that my mind should
— ~~not~~ be impressed by ^ no supernatural
— horrors. I do not ever remember
— having trembled at ~~a ghost story~~ tale of superstition or
— to have feared the apparition of a spirit
— ~~Ligh~~ Darkness had no effect upon my
— fancy and a churchyard was to
— me merely ^ as the receptacle of ~~rotten-b~~
— bodies deprived of life and ~~becoming~~ which
— from being the seat of beauty &
— strength ^ become food for the worm. ~~But~~
— ~~! A loathsome c~~ ~~But~~ now I was
— ~~obliged~~ led to examine the ~~cause~~ cause & progress
— of this decay and forced to spend days
— and nights in vaults and Charnel
— houses. I ~~was obliged~~ My attention was
— fixed upon every ~~horror of whic~~ ~~n~~ object ~~calculated to~~ the most insupportable to the delicacy of
— the human feelings. ~~are suscept able~~ –
— I saw how the fine form of ~~a~~ man
— ~~was became~~ degraded and wasted. I beheld the
— corruption of death succeed to the bloom
— -ing cheek of life – I saw how the worm ~~ste~~
— ~~ceeded to~~ inherited the wonders of the eye and
— brain. I paused, examin ~~ed~~ ing and anal ~~yzed~~ yzing
— ~~every minutiae of causation~~ untill
— from the midst of this darkness
— a sudden light broke in upon me.
— A light so brilliant & wondrous yet
— was
— all the minutiae
— of causation
— as exemplified in
— the change from
— life to death, &
— death to life,
—

- so simple that while ~~it intoxicat~~
- ~~ed me~~ I was surprised that I
- ~~was~~ among so many men of genius
- who had applied to the same science
- that I alone should discover
- this astonishing secret.
- Remember I am not recording the
- ~~no~~ vision ~~of~~ of a madman – the
- sun does not more certainly shine
- in the heavens than that wh ~~at~~ ich
- I now ~~record~~ affirm, is true. Some miracle
- might have produced it. But the
- stages of discovery were distinct
- and probable. After days and nights
- ~~of~~ of incredible ~~toil~~ labour and fatigue
- I succeeded in discovering the
- cause of generation & life. Nay
- ~~more~~, I ~~was~~ became myself capable of
- bestowing animation upon lifeless
- matter.
- ~~My~~ The surprise ~~that~~ which I at first experienced
- on this discovery soon gave place to
- delight and rapture. ~~After such~~
- ~~painful labour~~ ~~come~~ to arrive at once
- at the ~~object object~~ summit of my desires
- was the most gratifying circumstance
- that could have occurred. But this
- discovery was so great and overwhelm
- ing that ~~the reflection~~ all the
- I became dizzy
- with the immen
- sity of the prospect
- which it illus
- trated,
- After so much
- time spent in
- painful labour

steps ~~that~~ by which I had been progressively led to it were
obliterated. and I ~~saw~~ beheld only the result. What
had been the study and desire of the
~~in~~ wisest men since the creation of
the world was now ~~in~~ within my ~~hands~~: grasp; Not
that, like a magic ~~scene~~ scene it
all opened upon me at on e c e ; . ~~on~~
~~the contrary~~ ~~t~~ he ~~big~~ information
I had obtained was of a nature rather ~~one that~~
~~would~~ to direct my endeavours. ~~that~~
~~than show me the prospect with~~
~~any precise certainty~~. I was like the
Arabian ; who had been buried with
the dead, and found a passage to life
aided only by one glimmering and seem
ingly ineffectual light.
I see by your eagerness and the
wonder and hope which your eyes
express, my friend, that you expect to
be informed of the ~~secret~~ secret with
which I am acquainted ; ; ~~but you are~~ that cannot be.
~~mistaken~~ : Listen patiently to the end
of my story and you will easily
perceive why I am reserved upon that
subject.— ~~For why shoul d~~ I will not lead you
on, ~~as~~ unguarded and ardent as I then
was, to your ~~destruct~~ destruction &
so soon as I
should point
them towards
the object of
my search,
than to exhi
bit that ob-
ject already
accomplished.

— infallible misery. Learn from me, if
— not by my precepts at least by my exam
— ple, how dangerous is the acquirement
— of knowledge and how much happier
— that man is who believes his native
— . town the world, than he ~~nto who~~
— . aspires to become greater than his
— . nature ~~allows~~: will allow.

Chapter 6.
When I found ~~this~~ so astonishinga power
placed ~~in~~ within my hands, I hesitated a long time
concerning the ~~use~~ manner in which I should ~~make of~~ employ it.
Although I ~~conceived myself capable of~~ possessed
the capacity of bestowing animation yet
~~my~~ to ~~create~~ prepare a ~~creature~~ frame for the ~~receiving~~ reception of ~~t~~ it with all its intri
cacies of fibres muscles & veins ~~must be~~
a work of inconceivable labour & diffi
culty. I doubted at first whether I should
attempt the creation of a ~~creature~~ being
like ~~unto~~ myself or one of simpler
organization; ~~b~~ but my imagination
was too much exalted by my first success
to permit me to doubt of my ~~capacity~~
ability to ~~create~~ give life ~~a~~ to ~~creature being~~ an animal as complex
and wonderful as man. ~~Yet but But when I~~
~~when I looked around for considered my materials~~
~~they~~ my command hardly appeared adequate to so arduous
an undertaking; ~~but I did not despair~~ but I doubted not that I should ul -timately succeed.
~~I allowed that my first attempts might~~
~~be futile, my operations fail or my work~~
~~be imperfect; but I looked around on~~
the improvement ~~that~~ which every day
takes place in science and mechanics
~~and in my attempt was so much grande~~ I was encouraged to hope
~~and And altho although I could not hope~~
~~that~~ my present attempts would ~~s at le be in every~~
at least lay the foundations of future success
still remained
The materials
at present within
I prepared myself
for a multitude
of reverses, my
operations ~~might~~
be baffled ~~ever~~
incessantly, & at
last my work be
but imperfect,
yet, when I con
sidered

— — way perfect yet but I did not think that
— - the magnitude and grandeur complexity of my plan
— . w as any argument of its impracticabi
— . lity. And i I t was with these feelings that I
— began the creation of a human being.
— - As the smallness minuteness of the parts were formed a
— great hindrance to my speed I resolved,
— contrary to my first intention, to make
— . him of of a gigantic stature; that
— . is to say about 7 seven or eight feet in
— . height, and proportionably large. And
— after having formed this determination
— and having spent some months in
— - collecting of my materials, I began.
— . No one can conceive my the variety
— of feelings which pressed upon me
— during this time. When success raised
— me to enthusiasm life and death appear
— ed to me ideal bounds, which I
— should first break thro, and pour a
— torrent of light into our dark world.
— - A new creation existence would bless me as its
— . maker and source; many happy and
— - excellent creatures beings natures would owe their
— - existence in being to me. in manner
— - in a manner no father could claim
— . the gratitude of his child And pur
— . sueing my these reflections if I thought
— . that if I could bestow life animation upon
— . upon lifeless matter I might in
— process of time (although I now found
— Nor, could I
— consider
— the being
— successfully
— collecting &
— arranging
— creator
— so completely as
— I should deserve
— thiers

— it impossible) renew life where
— death had apparently devoted the
— body to corruption.
— These thoughts supported my
— spirits while I pursued my labours undertaking
— with unremitting eagerness ardour . My cheek
— - was pale with study, and pe my person
— . emaciated by confinement. sometimes
— on the very brink of certainty I faild
— yet I still clung to the hope which
— the next day or the nexhour next
— hour might realize. One secret
— which I alone knew possessed was the hope
— to which I clung and the moon
— gazed on my midnight labours
— while with unrelaxed & breathless
— eagerness I pursued nature to her
— most secret hiding places -But
— . who shall know my concieve the horrors of my secret operatio ns toil
— - as I dabbled among the unhallowed
— damp of the grave, or tortured the
— living animate-to-ani animal to
— - animate my the lifeless clay? Now my limbs
— . tremble and my eyes swim with the
— remembrance, but then a resistless
— and all almost frantic impulse urged me
— . on ; I seemed to have lost all
— . soul or sensation but for one
— pursuit. It was indeed a passing trance
— that only made me feel with renew
— had grown
— became
— now
— forward

— . ed acuteness **when** so soon as the unnatural sti
— . mulus ceas **ed** ing **had** to operate, and I had return
— ed to my old habits. I collected bones from
— Charnel houses and with profane fingers
— meddled with the secrets of the human
— frame. In a solitary chamber—or rather
— cell at the top of the house and seperated
— from all other appartments by a gallery
— and staircase I **h** kept my workshop
— of filthy creation; my eyeballs were
— starting from their sockets in at-
— . tending to the minutiae of **the** my
— employment. The dissecting room and
— the slaughter house furnished many
— of my materials, and often did my
— human nature turn from my
— occupation **but** **I** whilst **wa** **was** still urged
— on by an eagerness which perpetually encreased,
— . **as** my work **drew** near to a conclusion.
— . The **sums** Summer months
— . passed while I was thus **employed** engaged,
— heart and soul, in one pursuit. It
— was a most beautiful season: never
— did the fields bestow a more plentiful
— harvest, or the vines yeild a more
— luxuriant vintage. But my eyes were
— . **s** **hut** to the charms of nature & the
— . same feelings which **caused** made me **to**
— neglect the scenes around me caused
— me also to forget those friends who
— were so many miles absent and whom
— I had not seen for so long a time.
- I brought
- insensible

— I knew that my silence disquieted
— them and I well remembered the
— words of my father. “I know that while
— “you are pleased with yourself you
— “will **thing** think of us with affection
— . “and we shall hear regularly from
— “you. And you must pardon me
— “if I regard **you** any interruption
— . “in your corespondence, as a proof
— “that your other **studies** duties are equal-
— . “ly neglected” I **rembered** knew well
— . therefore what his **opinion** would
— be his feelings but I could not tear my thoughts
— from my occupation loathsome in
— itself but which had taken an
— **strong** hold of my **imagni** imagination.
— . I wished as it were to **proer** procras
— . tinate all that related to my feelings of affection, untill
— the great object **of my affection was** which swallowed up every habit
— . compleated.
— I then thought that my father
— would be **in** unjust **to** if he ascribed my
— neglect to vice or faultiness on my
— part; but I am now convinced
— that **I am** he was **in the right co conceive in** . A human
— being in perfection ought always to
— . preserve a **el** calm and peaceful
— mind and never to allow passion
— irresistible
— of my nature should be
— he was in the
— right in conceiv
— ing that I
— should not be
— altogether free
— from blame.
—

— or ^ a transitory desire to disturb his
— tranquillity. I do not think that the pursuit
— of knowledge is any exception to this rule.
— If the study to which you apply yourself
— . has a ~~d~~ tendency to weaken your affections
— and to destroy your taste for those simple
— pleasures in which no alloy can possibly
— mix then that study is certainly unlawful
— - that ~~it~~ is to say ~~on that~~ not befitting ~~to~~ the
— . human mind. If this ~~ru~~ rule ~~was~~ were al
— ways observed; if no man allowed any
— pursuit whatsoever to interfere with
— his tranquillity and his domestic affections
— Greece had never been enslaved, Cæsar
— would have spared his country, America
— would have been discovered more gradual
— ly, and the Empires of Mexico & Peru had
— not been destroyed.
— But I forget that I am moralizing
— in the most interesting part of my
— tale; and your looks remind me to
— proceed.
— My father made no reproach in his
— . letters, ~~an~~ and only took notice of my
— silence by enquiring more particularly
— . than before what my ~~eo~~ occupations
— . ~~were~~ were. Winter spring and summer
— . passed away during my ~~t~~ labours but
— I did not watch the blossom or the
— expanding leaves – sights which before
— had alway yeilded me supreme delight.
— - so ~~much~~ deeply was I ~~taken up with~~ engrossed in my

— occupation. The leaves of that year
— were withered before my work drew
— near a close. And now every day shewed
— me more plainly how well I had suc
— ceeded. But my enthusiasm was
— checked by my ~~am~~ anxiety and I appeared
— rather like one doomed by slavery
— to toil in the mines or any other
— unwholsome trade than an artist
— occupied in his favourite employment.
— Every ~~nigh~~ night a slow fever oppressed
— . me and I became ~~nevous~~ nervous to a ~~degre~~
— - most painful degree; a ~~fever~~ a dis-
— ease I regretted the more because I had
— hitherto enjoyed excellent health &
— ~~my nerves were fi~~ had always
— - boasted of ~~my~~ the firmness of my nerves. But I
— . believed that exercise and amusement
— would soon ~~driv~~ drive away ~~these~~ such sym-
— - p -toms and I promised myself both
— . of these when my creation should be
— comple ~~et~~ te ~~ed~~ . ~~Had had t then determined to~~
— - go to Geneva as soon as this should be
— . done and a in the midst of my
— . family find eve

Chapter 7th
It was on a dreary night of November
that I beheld ~~the frame on which~~ my man comple at te ed „ And
with an anxiety that almost amount
ed to agony I collected instruments of life
around me ~~and endeavour to~~ that I might e i nfuse a
spark of being into the lifeless thin k g
that lay at my feet. It was already
one in the morning, the rain pattered
dismally against the window panes, &
my candle was nearly burnt out, when
by the glimmer of the half extinguish-
ed light I saw the dull yellow eye of
the creature open.—It breathed hard,
and a convulsive motion agitated
its limbs.
But how How can I describe my
emotion at this catastrophe; or how deli
neate the wretch whom with such
infinite pains and care I had endeavoured
to form. His limbs were in proportion
and I had selected his features h as
handsome : Handsome Beautiful ; Great God! His
dun skin scarcely covered the work of
muscles and arteries beneath; his hair
was flowing and his teeth of a pearly white
ness but these luxuriancies only fomed
formed a more horrid contrast with
his watry eyes that seemed almost of
the same colour as the dun white
sockets in which they were set,
handsome beautiful.
yellow
of a lustrous black &

his shrivelled complexion and strait
black lips.
The different accidents of life are
not so changeable as the feelings of hu
man nature. I had worked hard for
nearly two years for the sole purpose
of infusing f life into an inanimate
body. For this I had deprived myself of
rest and heath health. I had desired
it with an ardour that far exceeded
moderation; but now that I had succeed
ed these dreams vanished and breathless
horror and disgust filled my heart.
Unable to endure the aspect of the creature being I
had created, I rushed out of the room and
remained continued a long time traversing my
bed chamber unable to compose my
mind to sleep. At lenght s l assitude
succeeded to the tumult I had before
endured, and I threw myself on my
bed in my clothes endeavouring to seek
a few few moments of forgetfulness.
But it was in vain; I slept indeed but
I was disturbed by the wildest dreams—
I saw Elizabeth in the bloom of health walking in the streets of
Ingolstadt; delighted & surprised I embraced
her but as I imprinted the first kiss
on her lips they became lurid with
the hue of death; her features appeared

— to change and I thought that I held
— . the corpse of my dead mother in my arms ; :
— . a A shroud envolepped her form & I saw
— the grave worms crawling in the folds of
— the flannel; I started from my sleep with horror, a
— . when I saw cold dew covered my forehead
— . my teeth ah chattered and every limb
— . was became convul s ed, when, by the dim and
— yellow light of the moon as it forced
— its way through the window shutters, I
— beheld the wretch — the miserable
— monster whom I had created; he hel d
— up the curtain, and his eyes—; if eyes
— they may be called,— were fixed on me—His
— . jaws opened and he muttered in some words
— while a grin wrinkled his cheeks. He
— might have spoken but I did not
— . hear — one had hand was stretched out
— . to detain me but I escaped and ran
— . rushed down the stair s ease I took refuge in
— a court-yard belonging to the house
— which I inhabited; where I remained
— the rest of the night walking up and
— down in the greatest agitation; listen
— ing attentively, catching and fearing each
— sound as if it were to announce the
— arrival of the demoniacal corpse to
— . which I had so miserabl e y given life.
— Oh! no mortal could support
— the horror of that countenance. A
— . mummy again endued with life animation could not be
— inarticulate
— sounds
— during

so hideous as He. I had gazed on him
while unfinished; and I thought he
was ugly then. But when those muscles
and joints were endued with motion
it became a thing to such as even Dante
could never have conceived.
I passed the night wretchedly—
sometimes my pulses beat so quickly t a nd
ha r dly that I felt the palpitation of
every artery: At others I nearly sunk
to the ground with thro languor and ex-
treme weakness. Surely so wretched a
creature as I never before existed.
Dreams that had been my food and
rest for so long a space were now
become a hell to me— t and the
change was so rapid, the overthrow
so complete.
Morning — dismal and wet — at leng ht th
dawned, and to discovered to my sleepless
and aching eyes the church of Ingols-
stadt its white steeple & the its clock which
pointed to the sixth e hour. The porter
opened the gates of the court which had
that night been my assylum and I
issued into the streets, pacing them with
quick steps as if I ough sought to
the wretch whom I feared every turn-
ing in the street would present to
and mingled
with this hor
ror I felt the
bitterness of
disapp
disappointment:
avoid

— . my view. I did not dare ~~to~~ return
— to the appartment which I inhabited but
— felt impelled to hurry on although
— . wetted by the ~~drizzling~~ rain which poured
— from a black and comfortless sky.
— I continued walking in this manner
— for some time endeavouring by bodily
— exercise to ease the load that weighed
— upon my mind. I traversed the streets
— without any clear conception of where
— I was or what I was doing: my heart
— . palpitated ~~with~~ in the sickness of fear and I hurried
— on with irregular steps not daring
— to look about me,
— . “Like one who on a lon ~~s~~ es ome road
— “doth walk in fear and dread
— “and having once turned round
— . walks on
— . “~~wat~~ And turns no more his head
— “Because he knows a frightful
— . fiend
— “doth close behind him tread.”
— Continueing thus, I came at lenght
— . ~~opposite~~ opposite to the Inn at which the dili
— -gences and carriages usually stopped. Here
— I paused I knew not why but remained
— some minutes with my eyes fixed on
— a coach that was coming towards me
— from the other end of the street.
— . As ~~†~~ it drew nearer I observed that it
— was the Swiss diligence; it stopped
— just where I was standing, and on
— . Coleridge’s
— “Ancient Mariner.”

the doors being opened I perceived Henry
Clerval, who on ~~seee~~ seeing me instantly
sprung out.
“My dear Frankenstein,” exclaimed he
“How glad I am to see you; how
“fortunate that you should be here at
the very moment of my alighting.”
Nothing could equal my delight
on ~~see~~ seing Clerval: his presence
brought back to my thoughts my fa-
ther, Elizabeth and all those scenes
of home so dear to my recollection.
I grasped his hand, and in a moment
forgot my horror and misfortune.
I felt suddenly, and for the first time ~~for~~ during for
many months, calm and serene
joy. I welcomed my friend therefore
in the most cordial manner &
we walked towards my colledge.
Clerval ~~ran-on~~ ~~talked~~ continued
talking for some time about ~~my~~ our mutual
friends and his owngood fortune in
being allowed to come to Ingolstadt.
“You may believe,” said he, “~~that~~
“it was not with ~~out~~ considerable
“trouble that I persuaded my
“father that it is not absolutely
“necessary for a merchant to
“know nothing except bookeeping

— “and indeed I believe I left him
— “incredulous to the last for his con
— “stant answer to my applications
— “was the same as that of the dutch school
— “master in the Vicar of Wakefield—
— ~~“I live very well yet I do not know~~
— ~~“Greek~~ “ I have ten thousand florins—
— “But his affection for me at
— “length overcame his dislike for
— “learning, and he permitted me
— “to under take a voyage of discoveryto the land of
— “knowledge.”
— “And my father, brothers & Eliza
— beth” said I
— “Very well & very happy” replied
— he “only a little uneasy that ~~yo~~
— “they hear from you so seldom, &
— “by the bye, I mean to lecture you
— “a little upon their account
— “myself– But my dear Frankenstein”
— continued he stopping short & gazing
— “full in my face “I did not before
— “remark how very ill you are. So thin
— “and pale; you appear as if you had
— “been watching for several nights.”
— “You have guessed right” I replied
— “I have lately been so engaged in
— ~~“ several studious~~ one occupation ~~s~~ that I ~~did~~
— “not allow ed myself sufficient rest as you
— ~~“ a year : r y~~ with
— “out greek –I
— “eat heartily
— “without greek
— of-
— have

— “see; but I hope, I sincerely hope all those
— “occupations are at an end—I am free
— “now I hope.”
— I trembled excessively: I could not
— bear to think of, & far less to allude
— to the occurences of the prece ~~e~~ ding
— night. ~~I continued to walk there~~ I
— walked therefore with a quick pace,
— and we soon arrived at my colledge.
— I then reflected – and the thought made
— me shiver that the creature whom
— I had left in my appartment might
— be still there—alive and walking
— about. I dreaded to see him but I
— dreaded still more that Henry should
— behold the monst ~~h~~ er. ~~I therefore~~
— entreat ~~ed~~ ing him therefore to remain a few
— minutes at the bottom of the
— stairs, ~~while~~ I darted up towards
— my own room. My hand was already
— on the lock before I recovered
— myself, when I paused and a cold
— shivering came over me. I threw
— the door open as children are accus
— tomed to do when they expect
— a spectre to stand in waiting for
— them on the other side. But
— nothing appeared. I stepped fearfully
— in – the appartment was empty, and
— my bedroon was also freed from its
— hideous guest. I could hardly ~~belief~~

— believe that so great a good fortune
— could have befallen me; but when
— . I ~~was~~ became assured that my enemy had
— indeed fled, I clapped my hands for
— joy and ran down to Henry.
— We ascended into my room & present
— ly the servant brought breakfast:
— but I was unable to contain my-
— self. It was not joy only that possess-
— -ed me,—I felt my flesh tingle with
— the excess of sensitiveness and my
— pulse beat rapidly. I was unable to
— remain for a single instant in
— the same place — I jumped over
— the chairs, clapped my hands & laughed
— aloud. Clerval at first attributed
— . my unusual spirits to joy ~~at~~ on his
— . arrival— but when ~~saw~~ he observed
— me more attentivelyhe saw a wildness in my eyes for
— which he could not account and
— my loud unrestrained heartless laugh
— -ter frightened and astonished him.
— My dear Frankenstein,” cried he “What
— . for God’s sake is the matter ~~for~~ do not
— . laugh so – ~~What has~~ How ill you are!
— What is the cause of all this?
— Do not ask me cried I, putting my
— . hands ~~fef~~ before my eyes, for I thought
— I saw the spectre glide into the

room – ~~Wh~~ He can tell! Oh save me
save ~~t~~ me”– I imagined that the
monster seized me I struggled furious
ly & fell down in a fit.
Poor Clerval! What must have been
his feelings. A ~~joy meti~~ meeting which
he had anticipated with such joy so
strangely turned to bitterness. But I
did not witness his grief for I was
~~senseless~~ lifeless and did not recover my
senses for ~~several~~ a long, long time.

— .
— .
—
—
—
— .
—
—
—
—
— .
—

- Chap. 7
— This was the commencement of a nervous
— fever which confined me for several
— months. And during all this time Henry was
— my only nurse. I afterwards learned that
— kn knowing my fathers advanced age
— and unfitness for so long a journey &
— wretched Elizabeth would be he
— had spared them this grief by partly conceal
— ing the extent of my disorder. He knew
— that I could not have a more kind
— & attentive nurse than himself, and
— firm in the hope he had of my recovery
— he did not doubt that instead of doing
— harm he performed the kindest action
— that he could towards them.
— But I was in reality very ill &
— surely nothing but the unbounded
— affection & unremitting attentions of
— my friend could have restored me to
— life. The form of the monster on whom
— I had bestowed life was for ever before
— myeyes, and I raved incessant incessantly
— concerning him. DoubtlessMy words no doubt
— surprised Henry – he at first believed
— them the wanderings of my disordered
— imagination but the continuance
— and per n t inacity with which I conti
— nually recurred to the same subject

astonished him: sta persuaded him that my
It was by very slow degrees and with
frequent relapses that alarmed &
grieved my friend that I recovered. I remember
that the first time I was capable of
observing outward objects with any kind
of pleasure, I perceived that the
fallen leaves had disappeared and that
young buds were shooting forth from
the trees. It was a divine spring & the
season no doubt contributed greatly
to my convalescence. I felt also senti
ments of joy and affection revive
in my bosom, my gloom disappeared and
in a short time I became as cheerful
as before I was attacked by the fatal
passion that consumed me .
“Dearest Clerval,” said I “How kind,
“how very good you are to me. This
“whole winter instead of spending it
“at in study as you promised yourself,
“has been consumed in my sick room:
“how shall I ever repay you? I feel
“the greatest remorse for the disap
“pointment I have been the e occa
“sion of– But you will forgive me.”
“You will repay me,” replied Henry,
“if you do not dis compose yourself;
disorder owed
its origin to
some uncommon
& terrible
event

— . “but get well as fast as you can . And
— “since you appear in such good
— “spirits I may speak to you on
— “one subject; may I not?”
— I trembled; one subject! What
— could it be? Could he allude to an object
— I dared not even think. Do not fright
— “en yourself;” said Clerval, who observed
— my change of colour;” I will not mention
— “it if it agitates you. But your father
— “and cousin would be so happy if they
— . “ree received a letter from you in
— “your own hand – They hardly know how
— “ill you have been, and are uneasy
— “at your long silence.”
— Is that all? “I said smiling
— “My dear Henry how could you suppose
— “that my first thoughts would not
— . “fly towards ~~that~~ those dear, dear friends
— “whom I love and who are so deserving
— “of my love.”
— “If this is your present temper”
— said Henry “you will be glad perhaps
— . “to see a letter ~~here~~ that has been
— . “ly lying ~~e~~ here some days it is from your
— “cousin I believe.”
— Ch V– 113
— He then put the following letter
— into my hands.
— “To V. Frankenstien
— . Geneva ~~Apri~~ March 18th 17—
— “My dear Cousin
— “I cannot describe to you the uneasi
— on whom

ness we have all felt concerning your
health. We cannot help imagining that
your friend Clerval conceals the ex
tent of your disorder, for it is now
several months since we have seen
your handwriting and all this time
you have been obliged to dictate to
Henry – Surely Victor you must have
been very ill and this makes us very wretched as much so . My father was almost
persuaded ~~of this~~ that you were indeed dangerously ill, and could hardly
be re f st rained from undertaking a journey to Ingolstadt.
~~I but I entreated him not to undertake it because for~~
~~although his health is better now~~
~~it has been since the death n tha t~~
~~fatigue of My beloved Aunt, yet the tha~~
~~have might make him very ill and~~
Clerval always wr ~~e~~ i tes that you
were getting better ~~and I l arden~~ eagerly hope you
will confirm this intelligence soon in your own
handwriting for indeed, indeed Victor
we are all very ~~uneasy~~ miserable on this account . Relieve
us from this fear and we shall
be the happiest creatures in the
world.– My uncles health ~~impro~~ is
now ~~well & far~~ vigorous that he appears
ten years younger since last
winter. Ernest also is so much im
proved, ~~so~~ that you would hardly
know him; he is now nearly sixteen
you know and has ~~quite~~ lost that
nearly as ~~t~~
after the death
of your dear
mother

— sickly appearance that he had
— some years ago – he is quite well & hearty
— . if I y may use that term for it is
— very expressive.
— . “My uncle and I conversed the
— last night a long time about what
— - Ernest should-be should follow . His constant
— ill health when young has deprived
— of the habit of application and now
— . that he enjoys good health we he
— . is continually in the open air on
— climbing the hills or rowing on the
— lake. I, therefore, proposed that
— he shouldbe a farmer which you
— know cousin is a favourite scheme
— of mine –A farmer’s is a very healthy
— . & happy life; and the least hurtful
— . or rather the most beneficial ofany
— . profession. of any. My father uncle had an
— . idea of his being educated as an advocate, & that through
— his interesthe might become a judge. But besides that
— he is not at all fit for such an
— - occupation, it is certainly better more honourable creditable to
— . to cultivate the earth for the suste
— . nance of man than it to be the
— - confid a nt & sometimes a helpmate the accomplice of
— . their his vices; which is the employment
— - of a Lawyer. And if he should become
— - a judge I said that a rich the occupation of a prosperous farmer
— if it were not a more honourable
— profession
— him
— &

— it was at least a happier employ
— ment than that of a judge, whose
— misfortune it was always to meddle
— with the dark side of human nature
— My uncle smiled and said that I
— g ou t ought to be an advocate myself;
— which put an end to the conversation
— on that subject
— And now I must tell you a little
— story that will please you. Do you
— not remember Ju Justine Martin ?
— Perhaps you do not I will therefore
— tell you her story in a few words. Mad.
— Martin her Mother was a widow with
— four children of whom this Justine
— was the third. This girl had always been
— the favou favourite of her father
— and by thro an odd perversity her Mother
— never could bear not endure her and after the
— death of M. Martin Moritz treated her very ill.
— My aunt observed this, and when Justine
— was ten twelve years old too prevailed
— on her mother to allow her to live
— at our house. Where she was taught
— all the duties of servant & was very
— kindly treated: I dare say that you now
— remember all about it, for Justine
— was a great favourite of yours, & I
— remember recollect you once said, that
— Moritz?
— but
— The republican
— institutions of our
— state country, have
— produced simpler
— & happier manners
— than those which
— prevail in the
— great monarchies
— that surround it.
— Ju Whilst
— Hence there
— is less dis-

— . if you were **a** in an ill humour
— one glance from Justine, could dissi
— . pate it **from** for the same reason
— that Ariosto gave concerning the
— beauty of Angelica:— she looked so
— frank hearted and happy. My Aunt
— **was very fond of her which caused** concieved an attachment for her, by which she was induced
— . **her to** to give her an **e** education
— superior to that which she had at
— . first intended . **and she** This benefit was fully
— . repaid; **for** Justine was the most
— grateful little creature in the
— world. I do not mean that she
— made any professions—I never
— . heard one pass her lips **w** but
— you could see by her eye that
— she almost adored her protectress.
— Although very gay, and in many respects
— inconsiderate, yet she paid the greatest
— attention to every gesture of my Aunt—
— . she thought her the **miracle** model of all
— . **perfection** excellence, and endeavoured to imi-
— tate her words and even her man-
— . ners, so that even now she **very** often **puts**
— **me in mind** of her. **observe You did not**
— **all this, nor did I at the time but**
— **it struck me afterwards when I**
— **reflected on the subject.**
— When my dearest Aunt died every
— one was too much occupied in their
— . -tinction **s** between
— the classes into
— which human
— beings have
— been divided,
— & the lower
— orders being
— neither so poor
— nor so despised
— are more
— refined & moral.
— A servant at
— Geneva does
— not mean the
— same thing as
— a servant in
— France or England
— . —Justine **was**
— thus recieved into
— our family to
— learn the duties
— of a servant, which
— in our fortunate
— country does not
— include a sacri-
— -fize of the digni-
— -ty of a human
— being.
— reminds

own **grif** grief to notice poor Justine
who had attended her during her **whole**
illness with the greatest affection.
Poor Justine was very ill but other
tryals were reserved for her.
One by one her brothers & sister
had died and her mother was now
with the exception of her neglected
daugher **was** left childless. The
conscience of the woman was troubled
and she began to think that the
deaths of her favourites was a judgement
sent from heaven to **punish** chastise her partialli **n t y**
she was a roman Catholic and I believe
her confessor encouraged the idea which she had concieved. . Accor-
dingly, a few Months after your depar-
ture for **i** l ngolstadt, **sh** Justine was called
home by her repentant Mother. Poor
girl she wept when she quitted our house
she was much altered since the death
of my aunt: grief had given soft **e n** ess
and a winning mildness to her manners
which had before been remarkable
for vivacity. Nor **did** was her residence
at her Mothers house of a nature to
restore her gaiety. The poor **fo** wo-
man was very vacillating in her
repentance. She sometimes begged
Justine to forgive her unkindness

— but much oftenor accused her
— . as having caused the deaths of ~~h~~ her
— brothers & sister. Perpetual fretting
— at last threw Mad. Martin into
— a decline, which at first encreased
— her irritability, but she is now at
— . rest for ever; ~~for~~ ~~S~~ she ~~did~~ died
— on the first approach of cold at
— . the beginning of th ~~e~~ is last winter ~~that~~
— ~~has just passed~~ . Justine has
— returned to us and I assure you
— I love her tenderly. She is very clever
— and extremely mild & pretty and as
— . I mentioned before ~~she is~~ her ~~air~~ mein and
— . expressions ~~are~~ continually remind me
— of my dear Aunt.
— . ~~And~~ I must say a few words to
— you also, My dear Victor, of little darling
— William. I wish you could see him. He
— is very tall of his age with sweet laughing
— . blue eyes ~~and~~ dark eyelashes and curling
— hair When he smiles two little dimples
— appear on his cheeks which are rosy
— with health — his chin comes down in
— . a beautiful oval ~~a~~ After this descrip
— tion I can only say what our visitors
— say a thousand times a day—'He is too
— pretty for a boy'.
— . ~~Miss Mansfeld~~ Now, dear Victor I dare
— her
— He has already
— had one or two
— little wives
— but Louisa
— . ~~M~~ ~~Cath~~ Biron
— is his favourite—
— a pretty little
— . girl of five years old ~~to~~

say ~~t~~ you wish to be indulged in a little
gossip about your acquaintance. The
pretty Miss Mansfeld has already received
~~on her~~ the congratulatory visits on her
approaching marriage with a young
Englishman, John ~~Me~~bourne Mel-
bourne Esq. Her ugly sister Manon
married M. Hofland the rich banker last
autumn. Your favourite schoolfellow
Louis Manoir ~~ma~~ has suffered several
misfortunes ~~d~~ since the departure
of Clerval from Geneva ~~b~~ But he
has ~~atready~~ already recovered his spirits
and he reported to ~~m~~ be on the point
of marrying a very lively pretty french
woman— Mad. Tavernier —She is a widow
and much older than Manoir but
she is much ~~adv~~ admired and a
favourite with every body.
I have written myself into good spi
rits, dear Cousin yet I can not conclude
without again anxiously enquiring
concerning your health— Dear Victor, if
you are not very ill write yourself
and make your father and all
of us happy or— I cannot bear to
Your very affectionate Cousin
~~dearrest~~ – dearest Victor Elizabeth Lavenza
write—
— think ~~of~~ on the
— other side
— of the question
— my tears al-
— ready flow

— “Dear, dear Elizabeth” I exclaimed
— when I had read her letter”—I will write
— instantly and relieve them from the
— great pain they must feel.”
— I wrote, and this exertion greatly
— . fatigued me; b y ut my convalescence was
— . commenced and on went proceeded regularly—in
— another fortnight I was able to
— leave my chamber.
— had

Chap. 8th
one of my first duties on my recovery was
to introduce Clerval to the several professors of
the university. And in doing this I under
went ~~torments~~ a kind of rough usage
~~that ill befitted~~ befitt ed ing the wounds that
my mind had sustained. Ever since the
fatal night – the end of my labours &
the beginning of my misfortunes { I had
conceived a violent antipathy even to
the name of ~~Ch~~ Chemistry Natural Philosophy . When I was other
wise quite restored to health the sight of a
Chemical instrument ~~brought on~~
~~again~~ renewed all the agony of my my nervous symtoms. ~~to~~
Henry saw this and had ~~p packed up~~ removed
all my ~~machines in a chest~~ apparatus from my ~~che~~ view he had also
changed my ~~room~~ ap ~~p~~ artment, for he perceived that
I had ~~a~~ acquired dislike to the room which had
previously been my workshop. But these
cares of Clerval were ~~thrown away~~ made of no avail when
I visited the professors. even my excellent
M. Waldman inflicted torture when
he praised with ~~the~~ kindness and warmth,
the astonishing progress that I had made
in the sciences. He soon perceived ~~my~~
disliked ~~of~~ the subject, but not guessing
the real cause he attributed ~~to it~~
to modesty ~~on hearing myself praised~~
that I
my feelings

— ~~he therefore~~ changed the subject from
— my improvement, to the science itself,
— with ~~an~~ a desire as I evidently saw
— of drawing ~~friend~~ me out. ~~K Kind~~
— ~~friend he tortured me without but~~
— ~~it How cruel is~~ What could I do?
— He meant to please ~~and me~~ & he
— ~~tortured me it was~~ I felt as if he ~~had~~
— carefully one by one ~~placed~~ in my
— view those instruments which were
— afterwards used in putting me to a
— slow and cruel ~~dre~~ death. I writhed
— under his words, yet dared not shew
— ~~my~~ the pain I felt. Clerval, whose
— eyes and feelings were always quick
— in discerning the sensations of others
— declined the subject alledging ~~in~~ his
— ignorance & the conversation took
— a more general turn. I thanked him
— from my heart, but I did not speak.
— I plainly saw that he was surprised,
— but he never attempted to draw
— my secret from me, and although
— I loved him with a mixture of
— ~~love~~ and reverence that knew no
— bounds, yet I could never ~~pr~~ persuade
— myself to confide to him that event
— which was so often present to my
— thoughts, but which I feared the detail
— to another would only impress more deeply.
— and
— tormented
— placed
— to be
— affection

Mr. Krempe was not equally docile ~~yet~~ & ~~weak~~
~~as my illness had made me~~ his harsh
blunt econiums gave me even more
pain ~~that~~ than the benevolent
approbation of M. Waldman —”Dam ~~m~~ n
“the fellow,” cried he “Why Mr. Clerval
“I tell you he has ~~beaut~~ outstript
“us all— ay stare if you please but
“it is nevertheless true – A youngster
“who but ~~two~~ three years ago believed
“Cornelius Agrippa ~~to be~~ as firmly as the gospel has
“now set himself at the head of
“the university & if he is not soon
“pulled down we shall all be out
“of countenance.—Aye, Aye, continued
“he observing my ~~countenance~~ face ex
“pressive of suffering “Mr. ~~f~~ Franken-
“stein is modest an excellent quality in
“a young man; Young men should be
“diffident of themselves you know Mr
“Clerval; I was myself when young but
“one soon grows out of that.”
Mr Krempe had now commenced
~~the subject of his own praise~~ an eulogy on himself and that
happily turned the conversation
from the subject that was so ~~painful~~ agonizing
to me.
Clerval was no natural philosopher.
His imagination was too vivid for
in my then
condition of
almost in-
-supportable
sensitiveness

— . the minutiae of science. ~~La~~ Lan
— . guages were his ~~chief~~ principal study for he
— . wished to open a field for ~~him~~ self-instruc
— . tion on his return – ~~Greek~~ Persian
— . & Arabic & Hebrew gained his atten
— . tion ~~when~~ he had become perfect
— ly master of the Greek & Latin langua
— ges. For my own part idleness had
— ever been irksome to me and
— now that I wished to fly from reflec
— tion and hated my former studies
— ~~a~~ I found great relief in being the
— fellow pupil ~~of~~ with my ~~fr~~ friend and
— ~~I not a only~~ found ~~instruct~~ not only instruc
— tion but consolation in the works of
— ~~the orientalists. There is something soothing~~
— Their melancholy is soothing and their
— joy elevating to a degree I never before
— experienced in ~~reading~~ studying ~~any~~ the authors of any other ~~books:~~ country.
— . When you read ~~s~~ their ~~fi~~ writings life
— appears to consist in a warm sun
— and gardens of roses – in the smiles &
— . ~~tears~~ of a fair enemy and the fire
— that consumes your own heart
— . How different from the man I y & ~~warlike~~
— . poet ~~s~~ ry of Greece & Rome.
— Summer passed away in these
— . ~~studies~~ & my return to Geneva was
— fixed for the latter end of Autum ~~m~~ n but
— so soon as
— frowns
— heroical
— occupations

being delayed by several accidents winter
& snow arrived, ~~and~~ the roads were
deemed impassable and my ~~return~~ journey
~~delayed~~ untill the ensuing spring. I felt this
delay very bitterly for I longed to see my
native ~~e~~ t own and my beloved friends
~~and~~ my return had only been delayed
so long from an unwillingness to leave
Clerval in a strange town before he
had become acquainted with its in
habitants. The winter however was ~~however s~~ spent
~~a~~ cheerfully ~~one~~ and although the
spring was uncommonly late when
it came its beauty compensated
~~for~~ its dilatoriness. ~~Ma~~ The month
of May was already ~~finis end~~ com-
pleted, and I expected daily the
letter that was to fix the date of
my ~~return~~ departure, When Henry proposed
a pedestrian tour in environs of
Ingolstadt that I might bid farewell
to the country I had so long in
habited.– I acceded with pleasure to
this propos ~~at~~ ition – I was fond of Exercise
and Clerval had always been my
favourite companion in ~~j~~ the rambles
of this nature that I had taken
among the scenes of my native coun
was
retarded

— try. We passed a fortnight in these —
— perambulations. My health and spirits had long —
— . been restored and they gained addi- tional vigour —
— . from the salubrious air ; I breathed, and the —
— conversation of my friend. Study had before —
— . rendered me unsocial ; I, — I had shunned the face —
— company of my fellow beings But Clerval —
— called forth the better feelings of my heart. —
— he again taught me to love the aspect —
— of nature and the cheerful faces of chil- —
— dren. Excellent Friend! How sincerely did you —
— love me and endeavour to elevate my —
— mind untill it was on a level with —
— . your own. A selfish pursuit e had cramped —
— . ed and narrowed it me untill your gentle —
— . ness & affection warmed & opened it my senses . and —
— . now I now became the same happy creature —
— who a few years ago, loving & beloved by —
— . all, had no sorrow or care – I and when —
— happy so no soul was more fitted than mine —
— for feeling delight in inanimate nature —
— . A serene sky filled and verdant s fields —
— . filled me with extasy.– T he present season was indeed —
— . divine – the flowers of spring blossomed bloomed in the —
— hedges while those of summer were al- —
— . ready in bud– I dis was not disturbed by —
— thoughts that during the preceeding —
— year pressed upon me not withstand- —
— ing my endeavours to throw them off with an invincible burthen. —
— . Henry a rejoiced in in my gaiety and —
— . sincerely sympathized in my joy feelings – he exer- —
— the natural —
— incidents of —
— our progress —
— had the —
— power of bes —
— . to towing on —
— me the most —
— delightful —
— sensations —

— ted himself to amuse me, while he expressed —
— the feelings that at filled his mind soul . The —
— resources of his mind on this occasion —
— were truly astonishing. As we rested during —
— the sultry heat of noon he invented —
— . his conversation was full of imagination —
— and very often, in imitation of the persi —
— an & Arabic writers, he invented tales —
— of great wonderful fancy and interest. At other —
— times he repeated my favourite poems —
— or drew me out into arguments which —
— he supported with great ingenuity. —
— We returned to our college on a sunday – the pea —
— sants were dancing and every one we —
— met appeared joyful and happy – my —
— own spirits were high and I bounded —
— along with a feelings of hilarity unbound —
— ed joy and hilarity. —
— unbridled —

- Chap. 9th
— On my return I found the following letter
- from my father.
- To V.–Frankenstein
— Geneva – June 2nd– 17—
- My dear Victor
— You have probably waited impati-
— . ently ~~the~~ for ~~the~~ a letter ~~which was~~ to fix
— - your return and I was at first tempted
— - to write a few lines ~~only to fix that~~ merely mentioning the day
— - ~~date~~ – but that would be a ~~very~~ cruel kindness
— and I dare not do it. What would be your
— . surprise ~~be~~ , my son ~~e~~ , when your ex-
— . pected a happy and gay welcome to ~~heho~~
— . beh ~~e~~ ld on the contrary tears and wretched
— ness. And how, Victor, can I relate our
— . misfortune ; ? absence cannot have rendered
— you callous to our joys and griefs and how
— can I inflict pain on an absent child.?
— I wish to prepare you for the woeful
— news but I know it is impossible; even
— now your eye skims over the page to
— seek the words which are to convey to
— you the horrible tidings.
— William is dead! That sweet child
— whose smiles delighted & warmed me
— who was so gentle yet so gay, Victor, he
- is Murdered!
— . I will not attempt to ~~e~~ console you
— but will simply relate the circumstances
— of the transaction.
- the date of
- on which
- I should
- expect you

Last thurday (May 26 28th) I; ~~my your cousin~~
my niece and your two brothers went to
walk in Plainpalais. The evening was
warm and serene, and we prolonged our
walk ~~fat~~ farther than usual. It was
~~ate~~ already dusk before we thought of
returning ~~When~~ and then we ~~found~~ discovered that Ernest
and William who had gone on before,
were not to be found. We accordingly
rested on a seat untill they should
return. Presently Ernest came ~~up~~ &
enquired for his brother he said that
he had been playing with ~~them~~ him
and that William had run away to
hide himself and that he had ~~wai~~ vainly
sought ~~fo~~ for him & afterwards wai
ted a long time but that he did
not return.
This rather alarmed us and we ~~sought~~
continued to search for himuntill night fell † ;
Elizabeth conjectured that he might have
returned to the house: ~~but~~ he was
not there – We returned again with torches
for I could not rest when I thought my
sweet child had lost himself, and
was exposed to all the damps & dews
of night; Elizabeth also suffered extreme
anguish. ~~We found him a~~ A bout ~~four~~
in the morning I discovered my lovely
boy whom the night before I had seen
when
seven

— blooming & active in health stretch
— ed on the grass livid and motionless—
— the print of the murderers finger was
- on his neck.
— He was conveyed home and the
- extreme wh misery anguish agony that was
— visible in my countenance revealed
— the secret to Elizabeth. She was extreme
- ly earnest to see the corpse. which ^ I for a
- long time refused attempted to prevent her but she persisted,
— and entering the room where it lay
— quickly hastily examined the neck of
- the victim and clasping her hads
- hands exclaimed— Go Oh God! I have
- murdered this sweet babe : my darling
- infant.
— She fainted and was retored with
- extreme difficulty; and when she again
— lived it was only to weep and sigh—
— She told me that that same evening
— William had teased her to let him
- we we wear a very valuable miniature
— she possessed of your Mother. This
— picture is gone and was doubtless
— the temptation which urged the mur
— derer to the deed. We have no trace
- of Come my dear Victor him at
— present of him, but altho our exertions are to discover him
— are unremitted; but they will not restore
— my beloved William.
— Come, dearest Victor, you alone can
- very
- At first I

console Elizabeth, who She weeps continually & accuses herself
of all howt so unjustly and yet her words
of th as the cause of his death—
pierce my heart. We are all unhappy
but that will not that be an additio
nal motive to for you, my eo son, to come return
and be our comforter. Your dear Mother!
Alas, Victor! I now say Thank God she did
not live to witness this grief — T t he cruel
miserable death of her youngest darling.
Come, Victor; not brooding w thoughts
of vengeance against the assassin but
with feelings of peace and gentleness
that will heal instead of festering the
wout wound s of our soul minds. Enter
the house of mourning, my son & friend
but with kindness and affection
for those who love you & not with
hat e red for your enemies.
Your affectionate & afflicted father
Alphonse Frankenstein
At
Clerval who had watched my countenance
as I read this letter was surprised in observ-
ing the despair that succeeded to the joy
I expressed on receiving news from my friends.
I threw the letter on the table and covered
my face with my hands.
“My dear Frankenstein,” exclaimed
hen Henry when he saw me weep with

— bitterness “are you always to be unhappy?
— “my dear friend, what has happened?”
— . I motioned to him to ~~read~~ take up the letter
— while I walked up & down the room
— . in the most extreme agitation. ~~Clerval~~
- ~~read the letter~~ – ~~and~~ tears also ~~gush~~
— . gushed also from ~~his~~ the eyes – “I can offer you
— . “no consolation, my friend,” said he ~~my~~
- “your ~~misfortune~~ disaster is irreperable. “ What
— “do you intend to do”?
— . “To go instantly to Geneva “ come
— with me, Clerval, to order the horses”
— . During our walk ~~€~~ Henry endeav-
— oured to raise my spirits– He did not
— do this by the common topics of ~~conversatio~~
— . consolation but ~~t~~ by shew ~~e~~ i ng the truest
— sympathy. “Poor William” said “that dear
— “child he now sleeps with his angel
— “mother. His friends mourn and weep but
— “he is at rest he does not now feel the
— . “murderers grasp – a ~~green~~ sod covers his
— “gentle form and he knows no pain–He
— “can no longer be a subject for pity his
— “survivors are the greatest sufferers and
— . “for them time is the ~~if~~ only consolation.
— “Those maxims of the stoics that death
— “was no evil and that the mind of man
— . “ought to be superior to ~~that~~ despair
— “on the eternal absence of a beloved
— “object ought not to be urged – even
— “Cato wept over the dead body of his
- “brother.”
- of Clerval
- as he read the
- account of my
- misfortune

— Clerval spoke this as we hurried
— ~~thou~~ through the streets the words
— . impressed themselves on my ~~memor~~
— . mind and I remembered them afterwads
— in solitude. ~~As soon~~ But now, as soon
— . as the horses arrived I hurried into
— a Cabriolet and ~~left Ingo~~ bad fare
— well to my friend.
— My journey was very melancholy.
— At first I wished to hurry on for I longed
— to console & sympathize withmy loved and
— sorrowing friends but when I drew
— near my ~~t~~ native town I sla c kened
— . my ~~pace~~ progress . ~~† €~~ I could hardly sustain
— . the multitude of feelings that
— ~~crowed~~ crowded into my mind. I passed
— . though ~~see~~ scenes familiar to my youth
— . but which I had not seen for nearly
— five years, how altered every thing might
— be ~~during~~ since that time? one great sudden
— . and desolating change had taken place
— but a thousand little circumstance
— might have ~~sapped worked~~ by ~~degreed~~ degrees
— . ~~worked~~ worked other ~~s t as great~~ alterations which although
— it might be done more tranquilly would
— not be less de ~~s~~ c isive. Fear overcame me
— . I dared ~~had N~~ not advance ~~fea~~ dreading
— . a ~~thoug~~ thousand nameless evils that
— made me tremble ~~while~~ although I ~~could not~~ was unable
— .

— to define them.
— . I remained ~~thus~~ at Lausanne for
— two days not daring to proceed. I contem
— plated the lake – the waters were
— placid – all around was calm and the
— Snowy mountains the “Palaces of Nature”
— were not changed. By degrees, this calm
— and heavenly scene restored me, and I
— ~~proceeded~~ journey towards Geneva. The road
— ran by the side of the lake which
— became narrower as I approached
— my native town – I discovered more
— distinctly the black sides of Jura;
— and the bright summit of Mount Blanc–
— I wept like a child– Dear mountains
— my own beautiful lake how do you
— welcome your wanderer Your sum
— mits are clear the sky and lake
— are blue is this to prognosticate peace
— or to mockat my unhappiness?
— . I fear, my friend ~~to~~ that I shall render myself
— tedious by dwelling on these preliminary
— circumstances but they were days of
— . comparative happiness and I ~~dwell~~ think
— . o ~~n~~ f them with pleasure – My Country
— my beloved country Who but a native can tell the
— delight I took in again beholding thy
— st r eams thy mountains and more than
— . all thy lovely lake ~~and~~
— . ~~Lo rd Byron~~
— continued my

— Yet as I drew nearer home grief and
— fear overcame me – night also closed
— round ~~me~~ and when I could hardly
— see the dark mountains I felt still
— more gloomily I pictured ~~to myself~~ f every
— evil and persuaded myself that
— ~~the most~~ I was destined to become
— the most w ~~h~~ retched of human beings–
— Alas! I ~~prho~~ prophesied truly and
— failed onlyin one single circumstance: that in all the misery
— I imagined and dreaded, I did not conceive
— ~~of~~ the hundredth part of the anguish
— ~~I~~ destined to ~~feel~~ : endure.
— I was
— .

- Chapter 10th
— . Night had closed in when I arrived **and**
— . the gates of Geneva were already **closed** shut and
— I determined to remain that night at
— - Secheron . The **night** sky was **very fine** serene and
— . **unable** as I was unable to rest I resolved
— - to **walk toward s** visit the spot where m y
— poor William had been murdered;
— as I walked I perceived a storm collecting
— on the other side of the lake. I saw the
— lightnings play in the most beautiful
— figures and gained a summit
— . that I might observe **the** its progress.
— - It advanced **slowly and** and I soon felt
— the rain coming slowly in large
— drops but its violence quickly encreased.
— I quitted my seat and walk on,
— although the darkness and storm aug
— mented every minute and the thunder
— burst **violently over** with a terrific
— - crash over my head — **William I ex**
— . **cried aloud — dear angel this is thy**
— - **funeral this thy dirge.** It was echoed
— from Salève the Jura and the Alps of Savoy—
— vivid flashes of lightning dazzled my
— . eyes, **and** illumin **ed** ating the lake; **and**
— then for an instant every thing
— - seemed of a pitchy **black** darkness **till** untill
— the eye recovered itself from the preceeding flash.
— . **A** The storm as is often the case in
— a village
— half a league
— to the east
— -ward of the city

that country Switzerland appeared at once in various
parts of the heavens. The most violent
storm **was** hung exactly **noth** north of the town
and at over that part **where** of the lake **turns** which **at** lies between
the promontory of Belrive and **changing** the
village of Copet **its course from South to north which**
it before p proceeds from west rsue s u e d
to east — another storm enlightened
Jura with faint flashes and another
appeared darkened and sometimes
disclosed the Mole – **the name of**
a peaked mountain to the east of
the lake.
While I watched the storm – so beauti
ful yet terrific I wandered **listlessly**
on with a hasty step – **I felt that**
th **is** e noble war in the sky elevated
my spirits; I clasped my hands & ex
claimed aloud “William, dear angel,
this is thy funeral, this thy dirge!”–
As I said these words **a flash of lightning** I perceived in the gloom
discovered to me a figure which stole from
behind a clump of trees near me – **I stood**
aghast its gigantc sta **n** ture **, its** & the deformity
of its aspect more hideous tha **t n a man could be** belongs to humanity
explain instantly informed me who it
was. It was the wretch, the filthy dæmon to
whom I had given life. What did he there?
Could he be (I shuddered at the conception
I stood
fixed gazing
intently, I
could not
be mista
ken a
flash of
lightning
illuminated
the object,
and discov
ered to me

— the murderer of my brother. No sooner
— did that idea cross my imagination than
— I became convinced of its truth — my teeth chattered
— . and I was forced to lean against ~~th~~ a
— tree for support — The figure quickly passed
— . me and I lost it in the gloom. ~~And h~~ H e
— was the murderer! ~~I could not doubt it~~ ed not my
— ~~the thought I was agonized by the bare probability was agony~~ — I thought of pur
— sueing the devil, but it would have been in vain for another
— . flash discovered him to me ~~climbing~~
— ~~up the steep and~~ hanging among the rocks of the nearly perpendicular
— ascent of the Mont-Salève; he soon reached
— . the summit and dissap ~~p~~ e ared.
— I remained motionless the thunder
— ceased but the rain still continued &
— . the scene was enveloped in a n ~~pitchy~~ impenetrable dark-
— ~~ness~~. I revolved in my mind ~~I revolved in~~
— ~~my mind~~ the events which I ~~u~~ had,
— untill now, sought to forget. The appearance
— ~~of the creature~~ the work of my own hands, alive at my bed side – & its departure.
— ~~its~~ ~~It was now nearly~~ two years had now nearly elapsed since the
— . night ~~of~~ on which he first received
— . life, and was this his first crime – ? Alas!
— I had turned loose in the world a depraved
— . wretch whose delight was in ~~deat~~
— . murder & wretchedness; ~~For~~ for had he
— not murdered my brother?
— No one can conceive of the anguish I
— . suff ~~er~~ e red during the remainder of the
— therefore
— Nothingin human
— shape could
— have destroyed
— that fair
— child. He
— was the
— murderer!
— I could not
— doubt it.
— The mere presence
— of the idea
— was an ir
— -resistible
— proof of the
— fact
— I resolved in my mind
— The whole
— train of my
— progress to-
— wards my
— creation

— night which I spent cold & wet in the open
— air. ~~cold and wet~~ . But I did not
— feel th ~~i~~ e ~~s~~ inconvenience of the weather. my imagination was busy in
— in ~~scene~~ scenes of ev ~~e~~ i l and despair
— I considered the ~~wh~~ ~~wretch~~ being whom I
— had cast in among mankind ~~for pu~~
— purposes of ~~mischief~~ horror such as ~~this~~ the deed which he had now done, nearly in the light
— of my ~~ow~~ vampire; my own spirit let
— loose from the grave and forced to
— destroy all who were dear to me.
— Day dawned and I directed my
— steps towards the town – the gates were
— open and I hastened to my father's
— house ~~s~~ .-My ~~n~~ first thought was to disco-
— ver what I knew of the murderer &
— cause instant ~~search~~ pursuit to
— be made. But I paused when I reflect-
— ed what the story was that I had
— to tell. A ~~creature~~ being whom I myself
— had created and endued with life, The
— ~~story~~ was utterly improbable and I knew
— well that if any other had ~~related~~ communicated such
— a ~~tale~~ relation to me I should have looked
— upon it as the ravings of delirium
— Besides the strange nature of the
— animal would ~~elude all the us~~
— elude pursuit, even if I were so far ~~believed~~
— ~~which was utterly impossible~~ as to persuade ~~its self~~ my relatives to commence it – ~~the com~~
— and
— endowed with
— the will &
— the power
— to effect
— had met
— me at mid
— night among
— the
— precipices of
— an inaccessi
— ble mountain
— tale
— credited

mon people would believe it to
be a real devil and who could attempt
a creature ~~that could~~ capable of scaling the
steep sides of Mont-Salève? These
reflections determined me, and I resolved
to ~~be~~ remain silent.
It was about five in the morning when
I entered my father's house. I told the servants
not to disturb the family, and went into
the library to attend their usual time of
rising. Five years had elapsed—passed as
a dream but for one indelible trace, and
I stood in the same place where I had last
embraced my father before my departure
for Ingolstadt. Beloved and respectable
parent! ~~His chair was before the reading
desk and a book open~~ He still remained
to me. I gazed on a picture of my mother
which stood over the mantelpiece. It was
an historical piece painted to please my
father and represented Caroline Beaumont
in an agony of despair kneeling by the coffin
of her dead father. Her garb was rustic, & her
cheek pale but there was an air of dignity
and beauty that hardly ~~allowed of~~ permitted the
~~feeling~~ sentiment of pity. Below this picture was a
miniature of William, and my tears
flowed when I looked upon it—While I was
thus engaged Ernest entered— he had heard
me arrive and hastened to welcome me.
He expressed the greatest delight on seeing
me – “Welcome my dearest Victor,” said he,
ah I wish you had come three ~~weeks~~
Besides of what use
would be pursuit?
Who could
arrest
overhanging

months ago and then you would have ~~been
welcomed as you ought~~ – But we are now
~~all of us~~ so unhappy that I am afraid
tears instead of smiles ~~for~~ will be your welcome
~~my~~ our father looks so sorrowful and it seems
to have revived in his mind his sorrow
for the death of Mamma and poor Eliza
beth is quite inconsolable.” Ernest began
to weep as he said these words.
“Do not you” said I, “welcome me thus; try
to be more calm ~~and not let prevent being my~~ e
that I may not be absolutely miserable the moment I enter
my father's house after so long an absence.
But tell me, How does my father support ~~s it~~
~~and if Elizabeth~~ his ~~f~~ misfortunes; and how
is my poor Elizabeth?”
She indeed requires consolation,” replied
Ernest—” She accused herself of having caused
the death of my brother and that made
her very, very wretched; but since the
murderer has been discovered”——”
“The murderer discovered!” Exclaimed I—
“Good God how can that be? Who could
attempt to pursue him? It is im
possible, one might as well try to
overtake the winds or confine a
mountain stream with a straw!
“I do not know what you mean” replied
Ernest, But we were all very unhappy
when she was discovered—No one would
~~one~~ believe it at first and even now
found
us all joy
ous & de
lighted

— — can Myrtella will not be convinced notwithstanding all the evidence. Indeed who could have believed that Justine Moritz, who was so amiable and fond of all the family could all at once become so extremely wicked.”

— . “Justine Moritz!” cried I, “im “poor, poor girl is she then accused – but it is wrongfully every one knows that. No one

— . bell believes it surely, Ernest?”

— “No one did at first,” said my brother,

— . “but several things circumstances came out, and her

— . “own behaviour was so has been such so confused but she

— “will tried today and you will then hear

— “all?”

— He then related that after some

— days of useless one of the magis search e t

— trates waited on my father and opened

— examine informed of his desire to search &

— the servants of the house —To this my fa-

— ther readily agreed being persuaded that

— all his domestics were per nothing cou

— fectly innocent. Justine had been

— morning that taken very ill the day after

— the murder of William had been discovered

— and been obliged to confine herself to

— her bed — Her apparel was exami

— . He then related that the morning

— . after on which the murder of poor William

— . had been discovered Justine o on the

— . bod Justine had been taken ill and

— confined to her bed, and after several

— Elizabeth

— will

— will

— forced

— conviction

— upon us

— . and as

— to add

— to the evidence

— of facts

— a weight

— that I

— fear leaves

— no hope

— for doubt:

days one of the servants happen ed s to ing to

examine the apparel she had worn on

the night of the murder & h ard ad discovered

in her pocket the picture of my mother

which had been judged to be the tempta

tion of the murderer. The servant instantly

shewed it to one of the others, and who without

saying a word to any of the family they

went to a magistrate who sent to appre

hend Justine. who on being charged with

the factshe confirmed the suspicion to

a in a great measure by her extreme

confusion.

This was a strange tale but it did

not shake my faith and I replied earnest

ly. “You are all mistaken. I know the

murderer Justine, poor, good Justine is

innocent.”

At that instant my father en-

tered and Ernest exclaimed Good God, Pa

pa! Victor says that he has d k knows

the murderer of poor William.

“And We do also, unfortunately,” replied my

father for indeed I had rather have

been for ever ignorant than, have discovered so

much depravity & ingratitude in one whom

I valued so highly.

“My dear father” exclaimed I—“You are

mistaken. Justine is innocent.”

“If she is” replied my father “God forbid

After our
first
mournful
greetings
had past
†

— - that she should suffer as **innocent**
— guilty – She is to be tried today and I hope I
— sincerely hope that she will be acquitted
— This speech calmed me. I was firmly con
— vinced in my own mind that Justine and
— indeed every human being was guiltless of
— this murder. I had no fear therefore
— that any circumstantial evidence could
— be brought forward strong enough to
— convict her and in this assurance I calmed
— myself expecting the trial with eagerness
— but without prognosticating an evil
— result.
- I saw unhappiness deeply impressed
— . **ee** on his countenance but he endea
— voured to welcome me cheerfully
— - and after **our** we **mournful** had exchanged our mournful greetings would have spoken on some
— other topic than that of our disaster
— had not
- he
.

Chap. 11
We were soon joined **By** by Elizabeth. Time
had made great alterations in her form since
I had last beheld her. Five years **ago** before
she was a pretty, good humoured girl **with an**
understanding above her years Whom every
one loved, and **humoured** caressed . She was now a woman
in stature and expression of countenance
which was uncommonly lovely — An open &
capacious for e head gave indications of a good
understanding joined to great frankness. Her
eyes were hazel and **very soft now through**
recent affliction they expressed sorrow. Her
smile had som express **ed** ive **great** of uncommon mildness now
through recent affliction allied to sadness–
Her hair was of a rich dark auburn her complexion fair and her
figure sli **m** ght and graceful. She **embraced**
w me with welcomed me with the greatest
affection “Your arrival, my **best** dearest cousin,”
said she, **give** “fills me with hope. You
perhaps will find out some means to
justify my poor **innocent** guiltless Justine. Alas
Who is safe is she were convicted of crime? **for**
I **belie** rely on **her** her innocence as cer
tainly as I do **on** upon my own. OurMisfortune is
doubly hard to us. † We have not only lost
that lovely darling boy but this poor girl
whom I sincerely love, is to be torn

— away by even a worse fate – Alas if she
— is condemned I shall never know joy more
— But she will not I am sure she will
— not and then I shall be happy again even
— . after the ~~d~~ sad death of my little William.”
— “She is innocent, my Elizabeth,” said I and
— that shall be proved – fear nothing but let
— your spirits be cheered by the assurance
— of her acquittal.
— “How kind your are,” replied Elizabeth,
— “every one else believes in her guilt, and
— that made me wretched ~~for I would as~~
— . ~~surely believe in my~~ for I knew ~~it to~~
— . ~~be~~ that it was impossible, and to see every one else
— prejudiced in so deadly a manner rendered
— me hopeless and despairing.” She wept—
— “Sweet niece” said my father dry your
— ~~eyes~~ tears ~~a welc- and do not give so sad~~ sorrowful
— . ~~come to Victor who has been so long~~
— . ~~absent~~ if she is as you believe innocent rely ~~that~~
— on the justice of our judges & the activity with
— which I shall prevent the slightest shadow of partiality.
— We passed a few sad hours untill eleven
— o'clock when the trial was to ~~begin~~ commence ~~and m~~ My ~~father~~
— . ~~and E father~~ El the rest of the family being obliged
— to attend as witnesses ~~lae~~ I accompanied them to
— the court. During the whole of this wretched
— mockery of justice I suffered living torture.
— It was to be decided whether the result of
— . my curiosity and lawless ~~desires~~ devices would cause

the death of two of my fellow beings. One a
smiling babe full of innocence and joy, the
other far more dreadfully murdered with
every agravation ~~ignominy~~ infamy that could
make that murder ~~more terrible~~ : memorable in horror. Justine
also was a girl of merit and possessed
qualities which promised to render her
~~little world~~ life happy; now all was to be oblite
rated in an ~~d~~ ignominious grave ~~-~~ ; And I the
cause! A thousand times rather would
I have confessed myself guilty of the crime
ascribed to Justine, but I was absent when
it was committed and such a declaration
would have been considered as the ravings of
a madman and could not have excul
pated her who suffered through me.
The ~~aff~~ appearance of Justine was
calm. She was dressed in ~~morn~~ mourning and
her countenance, always engaging, was rendered
by the solemnity of her feelings exquisite
-ly beautiful. ~~Yet she Her mann~~ Yet she
appeared confident in innocence and
did not tremble although gazed at and
execrated by thousands. ~~fo~~ For all the kind
ness which her beauty might have
gained from others was obliterated by
the remembrance of the enormity she was
supposed to have committed. She was
tranquil yet her tranquillity was evident

— constrained – and as her confusion had —
— before been adduced as a proof of her guilt —
— . she worked herself up her mind to an appear —
— ance of courage. When she entered the court —
— she threw her eyes round it and quickly dis —
— covered where we were seated – a tear seemed —
— to dim her eye when she saw us but she —
— . recovered herself and g with a look e of sorrow —
— ful affection seemed to attest her utter —
— guiltlessness. —
— — The trial began and listened attentive —
— . ly wish and after the advocate against her —
— had stated the charge several witnesses —
— were called. Several strange facts combined —
— against her which would have staggered —
— any one who had not such prof of her —
— innocence as I had. She had been out the —
— whole of the night on which the mur —
— der had been committed and towards —
— . morning had been perceived by a far me —
— woman not far from the spot where —
— the body of the murdered child had been —
— afterwards found. He asked her wh She The woman —
— . asked her what she did there?– for but she looked —
— . very stang strangely and only returned a —
— . confused answer e . S She came returned to —
— the house about eight o'clock and when —
— some one enquired where she had —
— passed the night she replied that she —
— . had been looking of for the child and enquired demanded —
— earnestly if any thing had been heard con —
— cerning him. When the body was brought —
— market- —
— & unin- —
— telligible —

— into the house she fell into violent hys- —
— terics and kept her bed for several —
— days. The picture was then produced —
— which the servant had found in her —
— pocket and when Elizabeth in a falte —
— ring voice proved that it was the same —
— she had which the an hour before the murder —
— the child had been missed,she had placed round —
— his neck a murmur of indignation —
— and horror filled the court. —
— Justine was then called on for —
— her defence. God kno who reads all —
— hearts knows how As the trial had —
— proceeded her countenance had altered. —
— Surprise horror and misery were strong —
— ly expressed. Sometimes she struggled —
— with her tears wh but when she —
— was desired to speak she collected her —
— powers and spoke in an audible although —
— variable voice. —
— “God knows,” she said, “ w how entirely I —
— am inocent. but I do not pretend to be —
— acquitted on account of my protestations —
— I rest my innocence a on a simple —
— explanation of the facts facts which have —
— been adduced against me, and I hope —
— the character I have always borne will —
— encline my judges to a favourable —
— interpretation where any fact circumstance appears —
— .

— doubtful or suspicious.
— By the permission of Mad Lavenza e ll
— I passed the evening with an aunt at
— Chêne. One of my cousins returning from
— Geneva said that he had been at the
— house of M. Frankenstein and
— She then related that by the
— permission of Elizabeth she had passed
— the evening of the night on which the
— murder was perpetrated at M the house of an aunt
— who resided in Chêne a village about
— a league from Geneva. On her return
— about nine o'clock she met a servant
— man who asked her if she had seen
— any thing of the child who was lost. She
— was frightened at this account, and passed
— several hours in looking for him when
— the gates of Geneva were shut and she
— passed several hours of the night in a
— cottage, but unable to rest or sleep, she
— rose early that she might again
— endeavour to find my brother. If she
— had gone near the spot e where his
— body lay it was without her knowledge
— and she had been confused That if she had been bewildered when ques
— tioned by the market woman, was
— that not surprising when she was so
— e was so wretched on for the loss of poor
— William. Concerning the picture she
— could give no account. "I know," continued
— at was forced to remain ed

the unhappy victim e "how heavily and fatally this
e one circumstance we weighs against me
but I have no power of explaining it and
when I have expressed my utter ignorance
I am only left w as any other is to conject ure
to conjecture concerning the probabilities
by which it might have been placed in
my pocket. But I here also I am at a checked
stand I believe that I have have no enemy on earth who
that I know and none surely who could have
been so wicked as d to destroy me so cruelly wantonly.
Did the murderer place it there? I know
of no opportunity afforded him for so doing
or if I had why should he have stolen
the jewel to part with it again so soon again ?
"I commit my cause to the justice of
my judges yet I see no room for hope. I
beg permission to have a few witnesses exam-
ined concerning my character and if the n ir
testimony shall not overweigh my supposed guilt is an apparent I shall must
be condemned although I p would pledge
my salvation on my innocence."
Several witnesses were called who had
known her for many years and they spoke
well of her but fear and hatred of the
crime of which they supposed her guilty
rendered them timorous and unwilling
to speak come forward . Elizabeth saw even this last
resource, her excellent and irreproacha
ble dispositions & conduct, about to fail

— . the accused, when although ~~uncalled~~
— she desired permission to speak. “I am”
— said she “the cousin of the unhappy
— child who was murdered or rather his
— sister for I was educated by and lived
— . with his parents ~~s~~ ever ~~sin~~ since and
— long before his birth; it may therefore
— be judged indecent in me to come
— forward on this occasion but when
— I see a fellow creature about to perish
— through the cowardice of her pretended
— friends I wish to be allowed to speak that
— I may say what I know of her character.
— ~~and I know a great deal~~ am well acquainted with it. ~~for~~ I have
— lived in the same house with her at
— one time for five and afterwards for
— . nearly two years. During all that ~~time~~ period
— she appeared to me a most amiable
— and benevolent creature. She nurst
— my aunt in her last illness with the
— greatest affection and care and after
— terwards attended her own mother during a
— . long & tedious illness ~~w~~ in a manner
— that excited the admiration of all
— who knew her. After which she again
— lived in my uncle’s house where she
— ~~—~~ was ~~always a favourite~~ beloved by all the family . ~~Of the deceased~~
— she was ~~very fond~~ warmly attached to ~~of~~ the child who has been murdered and acted towards
— him
— . ~~in~~ like a most affectionate Mother.
— for my own part I do not hesitate to
— . ~~s~~ ay that notwithstanding all the evidence
— violently
— agitated

— . against her I believe and rely ~~i~~ o n
— her perfect innocence. ~~An~~ She had
— no ~~t~~ temptation ~~and her dispo~~ character ~~whi~~ for such an action
— ~~is amiable for~~ as to the bauble on which
— the chief proof rests ~~If s t t~~ if she had
— earnestly wished for it I should have
— willingly given it her so much ~~did~~ do
— ~~I rely~~ I esteem and value her.”
— Excellent Elizabeth! A murmur
— of approbation ~~e~~ was heard, but it
— was ~~on her account~~ excited by her generous interference & not in favour
— of poor Justine on whom the public
— ~~ig~~ indignation was turned with renewed
— violence, charging her with the blackest in-
— gratitude. ~~For~~ She herself wept as
— Elizabeth spoke but she did not
— answer. My own agitation & anguish was extreme
— ~~wh~~ during the whole of the trial. ~~The~~
— ~~picture was~~ I believed in her inno-
— cence I knew it. Could the monster
— who had (I did not for a minute
— doubt) murdered my brother, alo in
— his hellish sporthave betrayed the inno-
— cent to death and ignominy. I could
— not sustain the horror of my situa-
— tion and when I saw that the popu-
— lar voice and the countenance of the
— produced

— . Judges had already condemned ~~her~~
— I rushed out of the court in agony. The
— tortures of the accused did not equal
— mine she was sustained by innocence
— but the fangs of remorse tore my bosom—
— I passed a night of unmingled wretched
— ness. In the morning I went to the
— court; my lips and throat were
— parched. I dared not ask the fatal
— question – but I was known and the
— officer guessed ~~what I came to en-~~ the cause of my visit
— . ~~quire;~~ — the ballots had been thrown
— . they were all ~~blak~~ black & Justine was
- condemned.
- ~~the accu~~
- ~~sed~~
- my un
- happy
- victim

Chapter 14
I cannot attempt to describe what I
then felt – I had ~~had~~ experienced sensations of horror
before and I have endeavoured to bestow
on them adequate expressions but now
words cannot convey any idea of the
heart sickening despair that I ~~then felt~~ endured .
~~Nor~~ The person to whom I had addressed
myself also added that Justine had al-
ready confessed her guilt. “That evidence” he
observed –”was hardly required in so glaring
a case but I ~~am~~ glad of it; and indeed
none of our judges like to condemn a
~~ch~~ criminal upon circumstantial evi-
dence ~~let it~~ be it ever so decisive.”
When I returned home Elizabeth
eagerly ~~enquired~~ demanded the result. “My cousin”
replied I, “it is decided as you may have
suspected – allJudges had rather that ten
innocent should suffer tha ~~t~~ n that
one guilty should escape: but she
has confessed.”
This was a ~~b~~ dire blow to poor Eliza
beth who had relied with firmness on
her innocence. “Alas!” said she “How
shall I ever again believe in human
benovolence – Justine, whom I loved and
esteemed as my sister. How could she
put on ~~thos~~ those smiles of innocence
only to betray– her mild eyes seemed inca

— pable of any severity or ill humour and
— . yet she has ~~com~~ committed a murder.”
— Soon after we heard that the
— poor victim had expressed a wish to
— see my cousin. My father wished her not
— to go but said that he left it to her
— own judgement and feelings to decide.
— “Yes,” said Elizabeth “I will go although
— she is guilty – and you Victor shall accom-
— . pany me –I cannot go alone”. ~~This~~ The
— idea of this visit was torture to me
— yet I could not refuse.
— We entered the gloomy prison cham-
— ber and beheld Justine sitting on some
— straw at the further end; her hands
— were manacled and her head rested
— . on her ~~knews~~ knees,– she rose on seeing
— . us and when ~~th~~ we were left alone
— with her she threw herself at the
— feet of Elizabeth weeping bitterly.
— My cousin wept also – Oh Justine
— said she, why did you rob me of my
— - last consolation – I ~~believed~~ relied ~~i~~ o n your
— innocence and although I was very
— . ~~wth~~ wretched I was not so miserable
— as I am now.”
— “And do you also believe that I am
— so very very wicked–?Cried Justine Do you also join
— with my enemies to crush me? Her
— . voice was suffocated ~~in~~ with sobs.
— “Rise my poor girl,” said Elizabeth
— “why do you kneel if you are innocent

I am not one of your enemies, I believed in
your innocence notwithstanding every
evidence untill I heard that you had
yourself declared your guilt. That report
you say is false, and be assured my
dear Justine nothing can for a minute
shake my confidence in you but
your own confession–”
“I did confess” said Justine “but
I confessed a lie. I confessed that I
might obtain absolution but now
that falsehood lies heavier at my
heart than all my other sins. The God
of heaven forgive me! Ever since I
was condemned my confessor has besieged
me,– he threatened and menaced untill
I almost began to think that I was
the wicked wretch he said I was. He
threatened excommunication and Hell
fire in my last moments if I con-
tinued obdurate. Dear Lady, I had none
to support me – all looked on me
as a wretch doom to ignominy and
perdition; what could I do? In an evil
hour I ~~confessed~~ subscribed to a lie
and now only I am truly miserable.” She
paused, weeping, and then continued.
“I thought with horror, my sweet lady,
that you should ~~sho~~ believe that

— your Justine whom your blessed
— aunt had so highly honoured and
— whom you loved, was a wretch capa
— . ble of a crime which ~~not~~ none but the
— - devil himself ~~was capable of~~ could have perpetrated . Dear
— William, dearest blessed child, I soon
— shall see you again in heaven &
— glory and that consoles me going as
— I am to suffer ignominy and de”ath.
— “Oh Justine” cried the weeping
— Elizabeth, “forgive me for having for
— . one moment distrusted you – ~~But~~
— why didyou confess? But do not mourn
— my dear girl, I will every where
— proclaim your innocence and will
— force belief. Yet you must die –
— you my companion, my playfellow,
— my more than sister— die –I never
— never can survive so horrible
— a misfortune”.
— “Dear Sweet lady,” do not weep”–
— . ~~sai~~ replied Justine”– you ought to
— . raise me ~~w~~ with thoughts of a better
— . ~~world~~ life , and elevate me from the
— petty cares of this world of injustice
— and strife –Do not you, excellent
— Elizabeth drive me to despair.”
— . Elizabeth ~~Em~~ embraced the suffer
— er “I will try to comfort you,” said she,

— but this I fear is an evil too deep and poignant
— to admit of consolation ~~or~~ for there is no hope
— Yet heaven bless thee, my dearest Justine,
— with resignation and ~~a hope~~ a confidence elevated
— beyond this world. Oh how I hate all its shews
— and mockeries.– When one creature is
— ~~deprived of life~~ murdered ~~they bel~~ another is immediately ~~mur~~
— ~~der~~ ~~another~~ of life in a slow torturing
— manner & then the executioners their hands yet reeking with the blood of in nocence believe that
— they have done
— great ~~things~~ deed . They call this retribution; hate
— ful name! When that word is pronounced
— I know that greater and more horrid
— punishments are going to be inflicted
— than the gloomiest tyrant has ever in
— ventented to satiatehis utmost revenge. Yet this
— is not consolation ~~to~~ for you, my Justine,
— unless indeed that you may glory
— in escaping so miserable a den. Alas!
— I would I were in peace with my aunt & my
— sweet William – ~~in peace~~ escaped
— from light which ~~I abhor~~ is hateful to me and the
— visages of men which ~~are hateful to~~
— ~~me~~: “ I abhor.
— Justine smiled languidly. “This, dear Lady
— said she is despair and not resignation.
— I must not learn the lesson that you
— would teach me – talk of somthing else
— ~~offields s~~ of something that will ~~brig jo~~
— bring joy and not encrease of misery.”
— deprive a
— .

— During this conversation I had retired
— to a corner of the prison-room where
— I could conceal the horrid anguish
— that possessed me— Despair! Who dared
— talk of that? The poor victim who
— on the morrow was to pass the
— dreary boundary of life & death felt
— not as I did — Such deep & bitter agony
— I gnashed my teeth and ground them
— together uttering a groan that came
— from my inmost soul. Justine started
— . and when she saw wh a o t it was
— she approached me. “Dear Sir,” said
— she, “you are very kind to visit me;
— you I hope do not believe that I am
— guilty.”
— . “I could not answer – “No Justine”
— . said Elizabeth; “he is even more
— convinced of your innocence than
— I was for even when he heard
— that you had confessed he did not
— . believe it.”
— “I truly thank him”— said Justine
— “In these last minutes I feel the
— sincerest gratitude for those who
— still think of me with kindness. How
— sweet is the affection of others to
— such a wretch as I am – It removes
— more than half my misfortune
— . and I feel as if I could die in pea
— credit

peace. thn now that my innocence is acknow
— ledged by you, sweet lady, and your cousin.”
— Thus the poor sufferer er tried
— to comfort others and herself. She indeed
— gained the resignation she wished for
— but I the true murderer w felt
— the never dying worm alive and I was which
— allowed no hope or consolation. Eliza
— beth also wept and was unhappy but
— hers also was also the misery of innocence
— like a cloud that that passes over the
— fair moon which & for a while
— hi des but cannot disturb destroy its brightness
— but misery & desp anguish and
— despair had penetr penetrated into
— the core of my heart – I bore a hell
— within me that nothing could diminish : extinguish.
— We staid several hours with Justine
— and with it was with great difficulty
— that Elizabeth tore herself away
— “I wish” cried she that I were to die
— with you – I cannot live in th e is world
— of misery.” Justine assumed an air
— of Cheerfullness whi ch le she with diffi
— culty repressed the bitter tears – “Farewell
— sweet lady, dearest Elizabeth may heaven
— in its bounty bless and preserve you
— that which

— May this be the last misfortune that
— you will ever suffer. – live & be happy
— to make of others so.
— As We returned Elizabeth said, You
— do not know, my dear Victor, w how
— much I am relieved now that I trust
— in the innocence of this unfortunate
— girl. I never could again have
— known peace if I had been deceived
— in my reliance on her. For the mo
— ment that I did believe it I felt
— such anguish that I could not have
— long sustained. Now my heart is light
— ened. The innocent suffers – but she
— whom I thought amiable and good
— is not wicked and I am consoled.”
— Amiable Sweet Cousin! Such were your
— thoughts mild and gentle as your
— dear eyes & gentle tone and voice.
— but I.— I was a wretch none &
— none ever conceived of the misery
— that I then suffered.

Chap. 13th
Nothing is more painful than when the
mind has been worked up by a quick
S succession of events, for a dead calm
of inaction and certainty to follows which and
deprives the mind soul both of hope or fear.
Justine died— She rested. But & I was alive
the blood flowed freely in my veins but
a weight of despair & remorse pressed
on my heart which nothing could remove—
our house was a house of mourning—
My fathers health was deeply shaken by
the horror of the recent events; Eliza
beth was sad and desponding—She no longer
took delight in her ordinary occupa
tions all pleasure seemed to her sacri
ledge towards the dead—eternal woe
and tears she then thought was the
just tribute she ought to pay to inno
cence thus blasted & destroyed Sleep fled
from my eyes. I wandered like an
evil spirit for I done had committed deeds of mischief beyond
description horrible, and hor more much more (I
persuaded my self) was yet in store.
Yet my heart overflowed with kind
ness and benevolence goodness – I had begun life
with benevolent intentions and thirsted for
the moment when I could put them in practise
of inaction & certainty
the dead calmness which

— and make myself useful to my fellow
— . beings. ~~But~~ ~~n~~ Now all was blasted; Instead
— . of seren ~~e~~ i ty of conscience which allowed me
— to look back on my actions with self satis
— faction, and from thence to gather promise of new hopes ~~like~~
— ~~- gay sweet-smelling flowers to spring up~~
— ~~regard to futurity with~~ . I was seized by
— remorse and guilt, and hurried away
— to a hell ~~no tongue~~ of intense tortures such as no language can
— describe.
— This state of mind ~~all~~ ~~t~~ ~~altered~~ preyed upon my health
— . which had ~~nearly~~ entirely recovered from the
— first shock it had sustained. I shunned
— the face of man; all sound of joy or
— complacency was torture to me; Solitude
— was my only consolation deep, dark, ~~night~~
— death-like solitude. My father observed
— with pain ~~how~~ the alteration perceptible in my dispositions & habits,
— ~~were altered~~ and endeavoured to reason
— with me on the folly of giving way to immo
— derate grief. “Do you think, Victor” said he
— . “That I do not suffer also— no one could love ~~d~~
— . a child more than I ~~did~~ loved your brother—
— (~~and~~ tears came ~~into~~ into his eyes as he
— said this) but is it not ~~th~~ ~~our~~ a duty ~~not to~~
— ~~add to the grief of~~ ~~owed~~ to the ~~ir~~ survivors
— ~~not to add to~~ their unhappiness by an appear
— ance of immoderate grief. It is also a duty
— owed to yourself; for excessive sorrow
— prevents improvement or enjoyment, or
— even the discharge of daily usefullness
— without which no man is fit for
— that we
— should re
— -frain from
— ~~adding to~~
— augmenting

society.”
This advice, although good, was utterly inna-
-plicable to my case; I should have been
the first to hide my grief and console
my friends if remorse had not mingled its
bitterness with my other sensations. Now
I could only answer my father with a
look of despair and endeavour to
hide myself from his view. About this
time ~~also~~ we retired to our house at
Belrive. This ~~cha~~ ~~ng~~ change was very
agreeable to me in particular. The
shutting of the gates of the town regularly
at ten o'clock and the impossibility of
~~stay ing~~ on the lake after that hour
rendered our residence within the
walls of Geneva very irksome to me.
I was now free: often, after the rest of
the family had retired for the night
I took the boat and passed the
night upon the water: sometimes
with my sails set I was carried by the
wind and sometimes after ~~we~~ rowing
into the middle of the lake I left the
boat to ~~take~~ pursue its own course and
~~followed~~ to my own miserable reflections.
I was often tempted ~~w~~ when all was ~~quiet~~ at peace
around me and I the only unquiet
thing that wandered restless in a scene
remaining
gave way

— so beautiful & heavenly; if I except
— alone some bat, or the frogs, whose harsh and
— interrupted croaking ~~of the frogs~~ **which** was
— **I** heard only when I approached the
— shore; often I say, I was tempted to
— plunge into the ~~still and~~ silent lake
— ~~and let~~ that the waters might close over me &
— my calamities for ever. But I was
— restrained when I thought of the heroic
— & suffering Elizabeth whom I tenderly
— loved, and whose existence was bound
— up in mine. And then I thought also
— of my father and surviving brother; **And**
— should I not by my base desertion leave
— them exposed & unprotected to the
— mali **s c e** of the fiend **I** whom I had
— let lose among them? At these
— moments I wept bitterly and wished
— that peace would revisit my mind
— that I might afford them consolation
— and happiness — but that could not
— be: remorse ~~took away~~ extinguished every hope—
— I had been the **cause** author of unalterable
— evil, and I lived in daily fear ~~that~~
— ~~the daemon of some new wickedness~~
— ~~which~~ let the monster whom I had
— created might **commit** perpetrate some new wickedness. —I had a n obscure feeling
— that all was not over, and that
— he would still commit some signal
— **if** only —

~~er~~ crime which by its enormity would
efface the recollection of the past. My
abhorrence of this fiend cannot be
conceived – When I thought of him I
gnashed my teeth my eyes became inflam
ed and I ardently wished to extinguish
that life which I had so thoughtlessly
bestowed. When I **though** reflected on his
crimes and malice, my hatred and
revenge burst all bounds of moderation
~~I wished but to see him again that I~~
~~might~~ I would have made a pilgrimage
to the highestpeak of the Andes could I when there
have precipitated him to their **foot** base ; I
wished but to see him again that
I might wreak the utmost extent of
anger on his head and avenge the
deaths of William and Justine.
Our house was **now** the house
of mourning, my father’s health was deeply
shaken by the horror of the recent
events. Elizabeth was sad and desponding
she no longer took delight in her
ordinary occupations; all pleasure seemed
to her sacrilege towards the dead; eter
woe and tea **s** rs she then thought was the
just tribute she should pay to innocence
so blasted and destroyed. She was no longer
that happy creature ~~she had been when~~
almost
There was
always scope
for fear so
long as any
thing that
I loved remained
alive.
nal

— — last saw her had — who wandered with —
— . on me on the banks of the lake —
— and talked with extacy of our future —
— . prospects— She was had become grave, and often —
— . talked of the inconstancy of fortune —
— and the instability of human life— —
— “When I reflect, my dear Cousin,” she said “on —
— the miserable death of Justine Moritz, I —
— . no longer see things the world and its —
— works in the same light as they before —
— . appeared to me. Before — Stories I looked upon the accounts of vice —
— and injustice that I read in books or heard —
— from others as tales of ancient days or —
— imaginary evils ; but now misery has —
— come home and men appear to me as —
— monsters thirsting for each others blood. —
— Yet I am certainly unjust.—Every one —
— believed that poor girl to be guilty, and —
— — if she had could have committed the crime for which she suffered, assuredly she would she not —
— have been —
— the most depraved of human creatures. For the —
— sake of a few jewels to have murdered —
— the son of her benefactor & friend, a child —
— whom she had nursed from its birth —
— and appeared to love as if it had been —
— . its her own. I could not consent to the —
— . death of any human being yet but certainly —
— . I should have thought such a woman being —
— — unworthy of life as unfit to remain in the society of men. — Yet she she was inno —
— . cent—I know — I feel she was innocent You —
— are of the same opinion and that —
— — confirms me. Alas, Victor! when lies appear falsehood look —
— who in earlier —
— youth had —
— conversed —
— At least they —
— were remote, —
— and more —
— . familiar to the —
— . bel reason than —
— to imagination —

— so like the truth, who can assure them —
— selves of certain happiness? I feel as if I —
— were walking on the edge of precipiece —
— towards which thousands are crowding & —
— endeavouring to plunge me into the —
— abyss.— William & Justine were assassi —
— nated and the murderer escap s es , wearing — .
— human lineaments; he walks about t d — .
— the world free & perhaps respected. —
— But if even if tomo I were condemned — .
— to suffer on the scaffold for the same —
— crimes I would not change places with —
— such a wretch.” —
— I listened to this discourse with the —
— extremest agony — I — not ind in deed — .
— but in effect was the true murderer.— —
— Elizabeth read my anguish in my counte —
— nance, and kindly taking my hand —
— said—”My dearest cousin, you must —
— calm yourself; these events have affect —
— ed me g G od knows how deeply! but I am — .
— not so wretched as you are. There is an —
— expression of misery and sometimes of —
— revenge in your countenance that —
— makes me tremble; be calm, my beloved best — .
— Victor, I e w ould sacrifice my life to your — .
— peace. We surely shall be happy; quite — .
— quiet in our native country and not —
— can look —

— mingling in the world what can dis
— -turb our tranquillity?”
— She shed tears as she said this
— . ~~but~~ but at the same time smiled, that
— she might chase away the fiend that
— lurked in my heart. My father who saw
— in the unhappiness that was painted in
— my face, only an exaggeration of that
— . ~~w~~ sorrow which I might naturally
— feel thought that an amusement
— suited to my taste would be the best
— means of restoring to me my wonted
— serenity – It was ~~th~~ fro ~~n~~ m this cause that
— . he ~~a~~ had removed to the country & ~~from~~
— the same reasons he now proposed
— . that ~~t~~ we should all ~~tak~~ take a
— journey to the Valley of C h amounix. I had
— been there before but Elizabeth & Ernest
— never had, and both had often ex
— pressed a wish to see this place which
— had been described to them as so wonderful
— & sublime. Accordingly we departed from
— Geneva on this tour about the middle
— . of the month of august ~~more than~~ nearly
— two months after the death of Justine.
— The weather was beautiful and if
— . mine ~~d~~ had been a sorrow to be chased
— away by any fleeting circumstance this
— voyage would certainly have had the
— effect ~~which~~ intended by my father ~~intended~~ . As it
—
— distrusting the
— very solace
— which she
— gave,
— induced by

— was I was somewhat interrested ~~and-sometimes~~ in the scene..it sometimes
— ~~amused~~ : ~~somehow~~ could not extinguish my grief. duringThe first day we travelled
— in a carriage. In the morning we
— had seen the mountains at a distance
— to which we gradually advanced. ~~B~~r
— We perceived that the valley through
— which we wound, and which was
— formed by the Arve whose course
— we followed, closed upon us by degrees
— and when the sun had set we
— saw immense mountains & preci
— pieces overhanging us on ~~each~~ every side
— . ~~of us~~ & heard the sound of ~~moun~~ the river raging
— ~~tain streams~~ among rocks, and the dashing of the
— waterfalls : around.
— The next day we pursued our
— journey on mules and as we ascended
— still higher; the valley assumed a
— more beautiful & verdant appear
— ance – Ruined castles ~~on~~ ^ ~~built~~ hanging on the precipices of piny mountains;
— the impetuous Arve, and cottages every
— here & there peeping from among the
— trees, formed a scene of singular
— beauty.. But it was augmented &
— rendered sublime by the mighty
— alps whose white & shining ~~pir~~
— pyramids & domes towered above
— all like ~~the~~ another earth —the
— lulled, it
—

— habitations of another race of beings
— ~~Soon after we entered the valley of e~~
— ~~Chamounix. This valley is more beauti~~
— ~~and sublime but not so beau ful~~
— We passed the bridge of Pellisier
— Pellissier, where the ravine which the
— river forms opened before us and
— we began to ascend the mountain
— which over hung it-. Soon after we
— entered the Valley of Chamounix. This
— valley is more wonderful and sublime
— but not so beautiful & picturesque
— as that of Servox; through which we
— had just passed. The high & snowy
— mountains w h ere its boundaries
— but t we saw no more ruined castles
— or fertile fields. Immense glaciers
— approached the road, and we heard
— the rumbling thunder of the falling
— Avelanche and marked the smoke
— of its passage.—Mont Blanc, the beau-
— tiful supreme & magnificent Mont Blanc raised itself from
— the surrounding aiguilles and its tremen-
— dous dome overlooked the valley.
— During this journey I sometimes joined
— Elizabeth and exerted myself to point
— out to her the various beauties of the
— scene.— And often I let my suffered
— my mule to lag behind & indulged
— wondeful

— in the misery of reflection. At other
— times I spurred on my mule the animal before
— my companions that I might forget
— them, the world, and more than
— all myself. When at a distance I
— alighted and threw myself on
— the grass to shut out weighed down
— by horror & despair. At eight in
— the evening we arrived at Chamou
— nix. Myrtella was My father & Elizabeth were very much fatigued.
— a Ernest who accompanied us was
— delighted and in high spirits— The
— only circumstance that detracted
— from his pleasure was the south wind
— and the rain that that wind seemed
— to promise us for the next day.
— We retired early to our appartments
— but not to sleep:— at least I did not. I
— remained many hours at the window
— watching the pallid lightning that played
— above Mont Blanc – and listening
— to the rushing of the Arve which
— ran before my window.

- Chap. 14
— The next day, contrary to the prognostics of our
— guides, was fine although clouded. We visited the
— source of the Aveiron and rode about the
— valley ~~the whole day~~ until evening . These sublime and
— magnificent scenes afforded me the greatest
— consolation that I was capable of receiving
— They elevated me from all littleness of feeling
— and although they ~~d~~ did not remove my
— grief they ~~t~~ subdued and tranquilized it.
— In some degree, also they diverted my mind
— from the thoughts over which it had brooded ~~over~~
— for the last month ~~s~~ . I returned in the
— evening, fatigued but less unhappy and convered
— with the family ~~t~~ with more cheerfulness than
— ~~I~~ had been ~~accustomed to~~ my custom for some time. My fa
— ther was pleased and Elizabeth overjoyed; “My
— dear Cousin,” said she, “You see what happiness
— you diffuse when you are ~~cheerful~~ happy ; do
— not relapse again!—
— The following morning the rain poured
— down in torrents and thick mists hid
— the summits of the mountains. I rose early
— but felt unusually melancholy. The rain
— depressed ~~my~~ me , my old feelings recurred
— and I was miserable. I knew how my father
— would be dissappointed at this sudden
— change and I wished to avoid him
— untill I had ~~rev~~ recovered myself so far
— as to conceal the feelings that overpowered
— me — I knew that they would remain
— that day at the inn and as I had

~~n~~ ever inured myself to rain and cold I
resolved ~~t~~ to go to the summit of
Montanvert ~~by myself~~ alone . I remembered
the effect the view of the tremendous
and ever moving glacier had ~~had~~
upon my mind when I first saw it
~~how i~~ t had then filled me with
a sublime extacy that gave wings
to the soul and allowed it to soar from
the ~~lower~~ obscure world to light & joy. The
sight of the awful & majestic in
nature had indeed always the effect
of ~~tranquillizing the~~ solemnizing my mind & causing
me to forget the ~~the~~ passing cares
of life. I determined to go ~~f~~ ~~by myself~~ alone
for I was well acquainted with the
path and the presence of another
~~had the effect of~~ would destroy ~~ing~~ the ~~solitary~~
solitary grandeur of the scene.
The ascent ~~to the mountain~~ is pre
cipitous ~~w~~ ~~with~~ but the path is cut into continual and short
windings which enable ~~s~~ ~~to~~ you
surmount the perpedicularity of
the mountains– It is a scene terrifical
ly desolate. In a thousand places the
traces of the winter avelanche may
be perceived where trees lie broken
and strewed on the ground; some
entirely destroyed others bent leaning
produced

— - upon ~~juts in~~ the jutting ~~corners~~ rocks of the
— mountain, or transversely upon other trees. The
— . path as you ~~ascen~~ ascend higher is inters
— - ~~persed~~ ected ~~wi th~~ by ravines of snow, down which
— stones continually roll from above;
— one of the them is particularly dange
— rous as the slightest sound such as even
— . speaking in a loud voice ~~is~~ produces a ~~suffi~~
— . ~~cien t d~~ concussion of air sufficient
— to draw destruction the head of the
— speaker. The pines here are not
— tall or luxuriant but they are sombre
— . and add an air of ~~gravit y~~ severity to the scene.
— I looked on the valley beneath.; Vast mist
— were rising from the river which ran
— . through ~~t~~ it and curling in thick wreaths
— around the opposite mountains
— whose summits were hid in the
— clouds, while rain poured from the
— dark sky and added to the melancholy
— impression I received from the objects
— around me — Alas! ~~who can boast~~ why
— does man boast of sensibilities above
— those apparent in the brute it only
— . renders them more necessary beings. ~~Hunger~~
— - ~~& desire and~~ If our impulses were
— confined to hunger thirst and desire
— . we might be ~~more~~ nearly free but now
— we are moved by every wind that
— . blows & by every ~~se~~ chance ~~work~~ word or
— uniform

— scene that that wind may convey to
— us
— . We rest, A dream has power to poison
— sleep
— . We rise one wandering thought pollutes
— the day
— . We feel conceive, or reason – laugh or weep
— Embrace fond woe or cast our cares
— away
— . It is the same –for be it joy or sorrow
— The path of its departure still is free
— Mans yesterday may ne’er be like
— his morrow
— . Nought may endure but mutability.
— It was noon when I arrived at the
— top of the ~~mountain~~ ascent . For some time I
— . sat upon the ~~the~~ rock that overlooks
— the sea of ice. A mist covered both
— . that and the surrounding ~~mo~~ untains
— Presently a breeze dissipated the mist
— and I descended on the ~~ice~~ glacier . ~~It is in tersper s~~
— - ~~sed with rifts~~ – The surface is very uneven
— rising like the waves of a troubled sea,
— decending ~~tow~~ low, & in ~~s t~~ erspered by rifts
— . that sink deep— The ~~width of the~~ field of
— - ice is ~~nearly~~ a ~~lege~~ league, in width, but I was
— nearly two hours in crossing it – The oppo
— site ~~t~~ mountain is a bare perpendicu
— lar rock.–From that side where I now
— stood Montanvert was exactly opposite
— at the distance of a league and above

— I should listen to the dæmon — my
— ainst feelings were ag it but the
— misery he expressed had al ready t
— compassion and I thought moved m y
— the least justice I could shew would
— be to listen to to his tale:
— We entered the hut — the monster
— lighted a fire and sitting by it he
— began thus:
— it rose Mont Blanc in awful majesty. I re
— mained in a recess of the rock gazing on
— this wonderful & stupedous scene – My heart
— before sad which was sorrowful ty , now swelled with somthing like
— joy tclas I exclaimed – Wandering spirits,
— if indeed ye wander and do not rest in
— your narrow beds, allow me this faint
— happiness or take me as your compa
— nion away from the joys of life.” As I
— said this I suddenly beheld a human the
— figure of a man at some distance advancing
— towards me with superhuman speed—
— He bounded over the crevices in the
— ice by among which I had walked with caution,
— his stature also as he approached seem
— ed to exceed that of man –I was
— troubled — a mist covered my eyes and
— I felt ready to pa faint faintness seize me. – The cold breeze
— of the mountains quickly restored me.
— But I perceived as he the shape came nearer
— the sea or
— rather the vast river of
— ice, wound among
— the its dependant
— mountains whose
— aerial summits
— hung over its
— recesses. Thier
— icy & glittering
— peaks shone
— in sunlight
— over the clouds.

(oh sight tremendous and abhorred) that it
was the wretch whom I had er created and
who had caused me such deep misery . I
trembled with rage an and horror determin I
ing resolv in ed g to wait his approach & then close
with him in mortal combat. He ap-
proached; I saw again that form from which
† His countenance bespoke bitter anguish
combined with d e i sdain and malignancy.
But I hardly scarcely observed this—anger and hatred
at f had at first deprived me of utterance
and I recovered only to overwhelm him
with express words expressive of utter
detestation and re and contempt – “Devil”
I exclaimed – “do you dare approach me
and do not you dread the fierce vengeance
of my arm wreaked on your miserable
head – Begone vile insect or rather Stay that
I may trample you to dust and oh that
I could with the end extinction of your miserable existence
restore those creatures whom you
have diabollically murdered”
“I expected this reception” said the dæmon
all men hate the wretched – how then
must O I be hated who am miserable
beyond conception or idea all living things. – Yet you
my my creator hate me and spurn me

— . me thy creature to whom thou art
— bound with ties only dissoluble by the
— . death of one of us. And y You wish purpose to kill
— . me. And h How dare you sport thus
— with life? Do your duty towards me
— and I will do mine towards you &
— the rest of mankind. If you comply with my conditions –I will leave them
— and you at peace – but as I am if
— . you do not comply with my condi
— . tions but if you refuse I will glut the t maw of death untill
— . he it be satiate satiated even with your
— dearest friends.”
— . “ Miserable wretch Abhorred monster,
— cried I furiously, fiend that thou art
— . the tortures of Hell are too soft for thee
— wretched devil! you reproach me
— with your creation; come, that I may
— extinguish the spark that I so negli
— gently bestowed.” My rage was without
— . bounds I sprung on him that I and
— . might destroy so hateful a monster– and impelled by all the feelings which can arm one
— He eluded me easily, and said – Be calm! I entreat
— h you to hear me, before you give vent
— . to your hatred upon my devoted head–. Have
— I not suffer r ed enough that you
— . should wish to encrease my misery–Life
— . although it be only an accumulation
— of anguish is dear to me and I will defend
— it remember thou hast made me more
— mild a
— . vengeance for
— thy crimes.
— being against
— the existence
— of another.
—

— powe r ful than thyself my height is superior
— to yours my joints more supple. But I
— do not wish to trave you will not be tempted to set myself in opposition to thee, I am thy
— creature and I wi th ll be even mild and docile
— to you , my gentle master my natural master & king , – if you thou will
— perform your thy part also, the which thou owest me dut y ies towards me. Oh Fran
— kenstein, do not be equitable to every other
— and trample upon me alone to whom thy
— justice & even mere charity they clemency, thy affection is most
— due. Remb Remember that I am
— . thy creature – I ought to be Thy Adam – or but I am rather the
— . fallen angel for whom thou driven from joy for no misdeed; every where I see
— . bliss from whi ile ch I alome am irrecoverably
— . wretched . I was benevolent and good:
— . misery made me a fiend. Make me
— happy and I shall again be virtuous
— Begone replied I – I cannot and
— will not hear you. there can be no
— . community between you and I– We are
— enemies — Begone or allhow let us try
— our streng h th in a fight in which
— . one must fall.”
— . > How How can I move you? said the
— . fiend— Will no entreaties cause you
— to turn a favourable eye upon thy
— creature who implores thy goodness and
— compassion – Believe me, Frankenstein
— I was benevolent —my soul glowed with
— to thee
— excluded
— .
— .

— love and humanity but am I not alone
— — miserably alone – ~~None to love me but~~
— — ~~all fly~~ and You, my creator abhor me
— — What hope ~~have I then from~~ can I gather from your
— . fellow creatures who owe me nothing. —They spurn and ~~abhor~~ hate
— me. The desert mountains and mournful
— glaciers are my refuge—I have wandered
— . here many days– The caves of ice ~~are my~~ which
— I only do not fear are a dwelling to me and
— the only one which man does not grudge
— — ~~to me~~ — ~~And food~~ – These bleak skies I
— — hail for they are kinder to me than ~~man~~ your fellow ~~creatures~~ beings
— — ~~and But I no They Man hate me and i s f~~
— . ~~they he~~ knew of my existence they would as you do
— . arm themselves for my destruction – ~~And~~
— . s S hall I not then hate them who abhor me
— . I will keep no ~~term~~ terms with my enemies ~~and~~
— I am miserable & they shall share my
— . wretchedness– Yet it is in your pow ~~re~~ er
— to recompense me and deliver them from
— — an evil which it ~~you~~ ~~have bestowed on them~~ .
— Let your compassion and justice be
— moved and do not disdain me. Listen
— to my tale ! when you have heard that
— . deny or comiserate ~~d~~ me as you shall
— . judge that I deserve–. But ~~here~~ hear me –The
— . guilty ~~may~~ are allowed by human laws,
— . bloody as they ~~are~~ may be , to speak in their own defence
— — before they are condemned Listen to me Frankenstein ~~for you are~~
— If the
— multitude
— of mankind
— only remains
— for you to
— make so
— great, that
— not only you
— & your family
— but thousands
— of others shall
— be swallowed
— up in the
— whirlwinds of
— its rage.

— you accuse me of muder and yet ~~wh~~
— you would with a ~~s~~ satisfi ~~e~~ ed conscience
— destroy ~~thy~~ thine own creature –Oh praise the eter
— nal justice of man!—Yet I ask you
— not to spare me, listen and then, if
— you can and if you will, destroy the work of your hands.”
— “Why” cried I–”do you ~~ever~~ call to my
— remembrance ~~those~~ circumstances of which
— I shudder to reflect ~~ever re-occured~~ that I have been the –
— Cursed be the ~~night o during which you~~
— day in which you first saw light, cursed
— (although I curse myself) be the hands
— that formed you!— You have made
— me wretched beyond expression You have left me no power to consider whether I am just to you
— or no. begone,
— relieve me from ~~they~~ your sight
— Thus I relieve you, Creator
— he replied & ~~He~~ placed his abhorred hand ~~s~~ before
— my eyes – ~~Thus will I relieve yo u~~ which I flung from me with violence – ~~Creator~~
— ~~he replied~~ –fro ~~n~~ m the sight of one whom
— you abhor.–still you can listen to me
— and grant me your compassion –By the
— the virtues I ~~e~~ once possessed I demand this
— of you – ~~Lis~~ Hear my ~~tale~~ tale –It is
— long and strange ~~but~~ and the temperature
— of this place is not fitting ~~y~~ to your
— fine sensations; come to the hut on ~~Motan~~ the mountain
— ~~vert~~ – The sun is yet high in the
— miserable
— origin
— & author

— - heavens – before it descends to ~~its lowest~~
— . hide itself behind ~~thes e~~ yon mountains and
— illuminates another world you will have
— . heard my story and can decide. ~~And~~
— on you it rests whether I quit for ever
— the habitations of man & lead a
— harmless life or become the scourge
— . of your fellow creatures, – & the author of your own speedy ruin.
— As he said this he led the way
— across the ice –I followed – my heart was
— full and I did not answer him but
— . ~~when~~ I weighed the various arguments
— - which he had used, ~~I felt enclined~~ & I determined at
— to listen to his tale—I was partly urged
— by curiosity, and compassion confirmed
— - me.– ~~As I was not~~ I had hitherto suppos
— ed him to be the murderer of my brother
— . and I ~~wished to find this either confirmed~~
— - ~~or denied~~ : For the first time also I felt
— what the duties of a creator towards his
— creature were and that I ought to
— render him happy before I complained
— of his wickedness. these motives urged me
— . to comply with his ~~request~~ demand – We crossed
— the ice therefore, and ascended the
— opposite rock.– The air was cold and
— the rain began again to descend–We
— entered the hut – the fiend with an
— air of exultation I with a heavy
— as I proceeded
— . least
— . I eagerly sought
— a confirma
— tion or denial
— of this opinion.

heart and depressed spirits – But I consented
to listen and ~~sitting~~ seating myself by the fire which he
lighted he thus ~~began~~ began his tale.

—
— .
— .

The first nations whose names ~~ever~~ are on record are Chaldea and ~~Eg~~ India. Tradition has preserved wonderful accounts of their progress in astronomical science. To them we owe the Zodiac and many observations on the motions of the heavenly bodies ~~w~~ which argue a much more accurate knowledge of that art than any succeeding country could boast ~~of u n~~ p til the time of Galileo and Newton. But their wisdom passed away from the earth leaving ~~but~~ faint traces ~~in~~ among the Egyptians a race of men ~~whose-of~~ whose minds ~~appear-to-have~~ bear a considerable affinity with ~~most~~ those of the Chinese. Both these ~~nations~~ people arrived at a certain point in refinement and knowledge and remained fixed: Superstition and slavery clouded their perceptions and a hatred of innovation, the never-failing attendant on ~~the mids~~ a mind ~~s~~ which ha ~~v s e~~ learnt every thing from imitation and nothing from itself, was the natural consequence of the ~~govern~~ arbitrary ~~t~~ government they obeyed. Their history both on account of its antiquity and the genius of the nation presents little more than a list of ~~m~~ names. Pride and a love of Conquest was the distinguishing characteristic of their kinds kings and ~~they displayed~~ their magnificence was displayed either by a bloody and useless ~~con~~ warfare on the liberties of their neighbours or by the ~~de~~ oppression and ~~destruet~~ destruction of their own subjects employed in the building of those famous pyramids, which, ~~shap~~ being scarcely more than shapless masses of brick or ~~and~~ stone, seem fitted to endure till the earth itself shall ~~pass-away~~: be no longer.

~~Slavery~~ The oppression of their own ~~monarchs~~ sovereigns fitted the necks of th ~~i e s~~ ~~people~~ Egyptians for the yoke of a foreign prince after a few generations they were subdued and remained for ages swallowed up in the great Persian monarchy till after the death of Alexander when they again ~~s ???????~~ became a n ~~separate~~ independant nation till the ~~y fell with of~~ overpowering force of the Roman Empire reduced them once more to the condition of a Province.

~~Conquest and warfare destruet destruction has have~~
~~Princes of Babylon of Princes~~
~~The names of princes and Simiramis are preserved~~
~~always dese by that bloody halo victory which glory and with conquest blood conquest y all~~
~~conquests rates its worshippers but the effects of their vi~~

soon forgotten and we hasten from this semi-barbarous on period to contemplate the glories of Greece whose his- in human nature tory tr triumph of we shall find the may meditate with complacency and triumphe and in-selecting names-&act and by challenge its detractors with names and and summing up the names-&actions that actions n orna embellish the pages of history through so long men through a series of years—they may existing While of Cyrus that who overturned their empire and founded his own on its ruins conducted on principles of utility and benevolence endured through the lapse of many ages:

~~C~~The Cyrus is contemplated with pe memory of ~~m~~ ~~Cy~~ culiar complacency by most historians. His humanity & ge him from love of justice distinguishes other conquerors to those w Cyrus was edu whom ambition was the ruling motive: ~~Cy~~ eated in the strictest simplicity early inured to fatigue ~~en~~ after the manners of the age, to consider glory and taught as the as the great and desirable bourne to which every virtue .But the natural exertions ous man ought to direct his steps mildness of his disposition led him the rather to seek for honour in the pardon than in the punishment of his and enemies: and if he conquered it was to bestow a more appeared to his conquests in light often the fallen nation f s as The romance with which of a blessing rather than a curse: Xenophon has embellished the history of this prince and anecdotes which he has the numerous ~~ane~~ either recor invented in his honour renders as apparent by better acquainted with the character of this monarch than of Inmemorable anecdotes are any other of ancient times: Xenophon recorded of his virtue and mildness by his-his but unfortunately this history must be rather regarded looked-upon as a romance than the real biography of the man; for al through tradition might probably preserve several of the prince private actions of so distinguished a man e is it yet the minuteness & regularity not probable that in ea Cyropedia must be narrations of the of detail which embellishes the entirely : ed-upon entirely as the invention of the writer historian How utterly The extent of our belie became forever entirely-incapa

- i + 64 leaves